Anguttara Nikāya

The Numerical Discourses

- Book One -



A New Translation

by

Bhikkhu Candana



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BOOK ONE

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Sabbadānaṃ Dhammadānaṃ Jināti

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Table of Contents

Dedication 28

INTRODUCTION 29

a brief note 34

Rūpādi (Citta Pariyādāna) Vagga 36

“Section on that which Dominates the Heart” 36

1 36

2 36

3 36

4 37

5 37

6 37

7 37

8 37

9 38

10 38

Nīvaraṇappahāna Vagga 39

“Giving Up the Obstacles” 39

11 39

12 39

13 39

14 40

15 40

16 40

17 41

18 41

19 41

20 42
Akammaniya Vagga 43
“Section on the Useless” 43
21 43
22 43
23 43
24 43
25 43
26 44
27 44
28 44
29 44
30 44
Adanta Vagga 45
“The Untamed Mind” 45
31 45
32 45
33 45
34 45
35 45
36 46
37 46
38 46
39 46
40 46
Paṇihita Accha Vagga 47
“Pointed in the Right Direction” 47
41 47
42 47

43 48
44 48
45 48
46 49
47 50
48 50
49 50
50 50
Accharāsaṅghāta Vagga 51
“The Snap of a Finger” 51
51 51
52 51
53 51
54 52
55 52
56 52
57 52
58 53
59 53
60 53
Vīriyārambhādi Vagga 54
“The Section on Arousing Energy” 54
61 54
62 54
63 54
64 55
65 55
66 55
67 55

68 56
69 56
70 56
Kalyāṇamittādi Vagga 57
“Genuinely Good Spiritual Friends” 57
71 57
72 57
73 57
74 58
75 58
76 58
77 58
78 59
79 59
80 59
81 59
Paṭhama Pamādādi Vagga 60
“On Careless Neglect – Part 1” 60
82 60
83 60
84 60
85 60
86 61
87 61
88 61
89 61
90 61
91 62
92 62

93 62
94 62
95 62
96 63
97 63
Dutiya Pamādādi Vagga 64
“On Careless Neglect – Part 2” 64
98 64
99 64
100 64
101 64
102 65
103 65
104 65
105 65
106 65
107 66
108 66
109 66
110 66
111 67
112 67
113 67
114 67
115 68
116 68
117 68
118 68
119 69

120 69
121 69
122 69
123 70
124 70
125 70
126 70
127 71
128 71
129 71
130 71
131 72
132 72
133 72
134 73
135 73
136 73
137 74
138 74
139 74
Adhamma Vagga 76
“What is non-Dhamma” 76
140 76
141 76
142 77
143 77
144 77
145 78
146 78

147 78
148 79
149 79
Anāpatti Vagga 80
“Not an Offence” 80
150 80
151 80
152 80
153 81
154 81
155 81
156 82
157 82
158 82
159 83
160 83
161 83
162 84
163 84
164 84
165 85
166 85
167 85
168 86
169 86
Ekapuggala Vagga 87
“The One Person” 87
170 87
171 87

172 87
173 88
174 88
175 88
176 89
177 89
178 89
179 89
180 90
181 90
182 90
183 91
184 91
185 91
186 91
187 92
Etadagga Vagga 93
“The Chief – From Each Category” 93
188 93
189 93
190 93
191 93
192 93
193 94
194 94
195 94
196 94
197 94
Dutiya Vagga 94
The Second Sub Group 94

198 94
199 95
200 95
201 95
202 95
203 95
204 95
205 95
206 96
207 96
208 96
Tatiya Vagga 96
The Third Sub Group 96
209 96
210 96
211 96
212 97
213 97
214 97
215 97
216 97
217 97
218 98
Catuttha Vagga 98
The Fourth Sub Group 98
219 98
220 98
221 98
222 98
223 98

224 99
225 99
226 99
227 99
228 99
229 99
230 99
231 100
232 100
233 100
234 100
Pañcama Vagga 100
The Fifth Sub Group 100
235 100
236 100
237 101
238 101
239 101
240 101
241 101
242 101
243 101
244 102
245 102
246 102
247 102
Chaṭṭha Vagga 102
The Sixth Sub Group 102
248 102
249 102

250 103
251 103
252 103
253 103
254 103
255 103
256 104
257 104
Sattama Vagga 104
The Seventh Sub Group 104
258 104
259 104
260 104
261 104
262 105
263 105
264 105
265 105
266 105
267 105
Aṭṭhānapali Vagga 106
“The Impossibilities” 106
Paṭhama Vagga 106
The First Sub Group 106
268 106
269 106
270 107
271 107
272 107
273 107

274 107
275 108
276 108
277 108
Dutiya Vagga 108
The Second Sub Group 108
278 108
279 109
280 109
281 109
282 109
283 110
284 110
285 110
286 110
Tatiya Vagga 111
The Third Sub Group 111
287 111
288 111
289 111
290 111
291 112
292 112
293 112
294 113
295 113
Ekādhammo Vagga 114
“The One Singular Thing” 114
Paṭhama Vagga 114
The First Sub Group 114
296 114

297 114
298 115
299 115
300 116
301 116
302 116
303 117
304 117
305 118
Dutiya Vagga 118
The Second Sub Group 118
306 118
307 118
308 119
309 119
310 119
311 119
312 120
313 120
314 120
315 121
Tatiya Vagga 122
The Third Sub Group 122
316 122
317 122
318 123
319 123
320 123
321 124
322 124

323 124
324 125
325 125
326 125
327 125
328 126
329 126
330 126
331 126
332 126
Catuttha Vagga 127
The Fourth Sub Group 127
333 127
334 127
335 127
336 127
337 128
338 128
339 128
340 128
341 128
342 129
343 129
344 129
345 129
346 129
347 130
348 130
349 130
350 131

351 131
352 131
353 131
354 131
355 132
356 132
357 132
358 132
359 132
360 132
361 133
362 133
363 133
364 133
365 133
366 134
367 134
368 134
369 134
370 134
371 135
372 135
373 135
374 135
375 135
376 136
377 136
Pasakaradhamma Vagga 137
“Qualities that Should Be Aspired To” 137

378 137
379 137
380 137
381 137
382 137
383 138
384 138
385 138
386 138
387 138
388 138
389 139
390 139
391 139
392 139
393 139
Apara Accharāsaṅghāta Vagga 140
“Another Section on the ‘Snap of a Finger’” 140
394 140
395 140
396 140
397 141
398 141
399 141
400 142
401 142
402 142
403 143
404 143

405..... 143
406..... 144
407..... 144
408..... 144
409..... 145
410..... 145
411..... 145
412..... 146
413..... 146
414..... 146
415..... 147
416..... 147
417..... 147
418..... 147
419..... 148
420..... 148
421..... 148
422..... 149
423..... 149
424..... 149
425..... 150
426..... 150
427..... 150
428..... 151
429..... 151
430..... 151
431..... 151
432..... 152
433..... 152

434..... 152
435..... 153
436..... 153
437..... 153
438..... 154
439..... 154
440..... 154
441..... 155
442..... 155
443..... 155
444..... 156
445..... 156
446..... 156
447..... 157
448..... 157
449..... 157
450..... 158
451..... 158
452..... 158
453..... 159
454..... 159
455..... 159
456..... 160
457..... 160
458..... 160
459..... 160
460..... 161
461..... 161
462..... 161

463..... 161
464..... 162
465..... 162
466..... 162
467..... 163
468..... 163
469..... 163
470..... 163
471..... 164
472..... 164
473..... 164
474..... 165
475..... 165
476..... 165
477..... 165
478..... 166
479..... 166
480..... 166
481..... 167
482..... 167
483..... 167
484..... 167
485..... 168
486..... 168
487..... 168
488..... 169
489..... 169
490..... 169
491..... 169

492..... 170
493..... 170
494..... 170
495..... 170
496..... 171
497..... 171
498..... 171
499..... 172
500..... 172
501..... 172
502..... 172
503..... 173
504..... 173
505..... 173
506..... 174
507..... 174
508..... 174
509..... 174
510..... 175
511..... 175
512..... 175
513..... 176
514..... 176
515..... 176
516..... 176
517..... 177
518..... 177
519..... 177
520..... 178

521 178
522 178
523 178
524 179
526 179
527 180
528 180
529 180
530 180
531 181
532 181
533 181
534 182
535 182
536 182
537 182
538 183
539 183
540 183
541 184
542 184
543 184
544 184
545 185
546 185
547 185
548 186
549 186
550 186

551 186
552 187
553 187
554 187
555 188
556 188
557 188
558 188
559 189
560 189
561 189
562 190
563 190
564 190
565 190
566 191
567 191
568 191
569 192
570 192
571 192
572 192
573 193
574 193
Kāyagatāsati Vagga 194
“Mindfulness Anchored Upon the Body” 194
575 194
576 194
577 194

578..... 195
579..... 195
580..... 195
581..... 196
582..... 196
583..... 196
584..... 197
585..... 197
586..... 198
587..... 198
588..... 198
589..... 198
590..... 199
591..... 199
592..... 199
593..... 200
594..... 200
595..... 200
596..... 200
597..... 201
598..... 201
599..... 201
600..... 202
601..... 202
602..... 202
603..... 203
604..... 203
605..... 203
606..... 204

607 204
608 204
609 205
610 205
611 205
612 206
613 206
614 206
615 207
Amata Vagga 208
“The Deathless” 208
616 208
617 208
618 208
619 209
620 209
621 209
622 209
623 209
624 210
625 210
626 210
627 210
a final note 212

Dedication

This work is reverently and lovingly dedicated to the late Venerable Bhikkhu Kaṭukurunde Ñāṇananda, a true Noble Son of The Blessed One, whose fearless clarity, meditative depth of understanding, and unwavering fidelity to the early word of The Buddha rekindled the living flame of The Dhamma in our time. Therefore, with a heart overflowing with profound gratitude and deep admiration, I bow in veneration to my late teacher, acknowledging him as the greatest inspiration behind this undertaking. May the merits arisen here be shared in his honor, and may his example continue to guide sincere seekers back to the luminous simplicity of The Teaching, revealed to existence by The Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddha.

Also, this work could not have been possible without the care and attention of my late parents and teachers, as well as students and all those supporters, whose hearts resonate to the same tune, that is the unmistakable love for The Dhamma.

With profound gratitude and a heart full of devotion, I humbly dedicate this work to The Triple Gem and The Truly Holy Noble Disciples, who have crossed the flood. Their wisdom and compassion have shaped my understanding, and it is with deep reverence that I offer this translation of the Anguttara Nikāya, a cornerstone of the Buddhist Pāli Canon, to posterity.

As a practitioner, psychotherapist, and teacher, I embarked on this solitary journey, weaving together years of academic study and meditative practice. The result is a comprehensive and nuanced translation that seeks to capture the essence of the *suttas* (discourses) in their entirety.

In the spirit of preserving the authenticity of Lord Buddha's Teachings, i.e. The Dhamma, this translation endeavors to include all sections almost always omitted by others for the sake of brevity. Every discourse, every verse, and every lesson within these sacred texts have been meticulously examined and presented, sparing neither time nor energy to ensure a faithful rendering.

As the world grapples with uncertainty and strife, may this humble offering serve as a beacon of light, a gift of Dhamma to those in need.

Whatever countless merits have been gained by supporters of this project and of my life and work, as a Bhikkhu in this changing world, may their rewards perpetually increase, exponentially, protecting The Sāsana and the genuine Teachings of Lord Buddha, which are being polluted daily and driven to extinction, as predicted By Lord Buddha Himself.

May the Blessings of the Triple Gem be with you, in your hearts, always…

Mettācittenā,
Bhikkhu Candana
Buddhist Era 2569 (2026)

INTRODUCTION

A New Translation of Anguttara Nikāya: The Numerical Discourses

The **Anguttara Nikāya**, the "Collection of Discourses Arranged by Number," is one of the most elegantly practical repositories of The Buddha's Teachings. Its structure reflects a natural law of learning: that profound understanding arises from the gradual accumulation and integration of simple principles. By organizing The Dhamma into numerical sets – ones, twos, threes, and so forth – the collection offers a path that is both systematic and organic, resonating equally with the newly interested reader and the dedicated practitioner.

Unlike texts shaped by philosophical argument or doctrinal exposition, the Anguttara Nikāya thrives on **direct encounters**: The Buddha addressing a monk struggling with his duties, a layperson navigating ethical challenges, a king pondering governance, or a wanderer seeking clarity. These dialogues reveal something essential about The Dhamma: that it was *never* meant to float in abstraction, but to be met within the "living laboratory" of human experience.

The very structure of the collection highlights the **relatability** and *contextual intimacy* of the Teaching, where each sutta emerges from specific people in specific circumstances – moments of confusion, insight, conflict, or breakthrough. The Dhamma is shown as it actually operated in the world: clear, compassionate, precise, and always geared toward Release.

This translation is part of a larger undertaking that has been developing over the course of more than seven years. The project began as an effort to **narrate** large sections of the Pāli Canon, driven by a simple but sincere aspiration to make the suttas directly accessible to anyone, anywhere, without cost or barriers. Narration gradually revealed textual inconsistencies, missing repetitions, and interpretive issues that required urgent attention. What began as narration, therefore, expanded into a full-scale, line-by-line **retranslation** of the Nikāyas.

Throughout this work, I have adhered to a few essential principles.

The first is **faithfulness to the Pāli**, including a devoted restoration of the many repetitions that have been removed by editors over the centuries. These repetitions are ***not*** ornamental flourishes. They are the heartbeat of an oral tradition that preserved The Dhamma for centuries before a single word was written. Their rhythm reinforces memory, emphasis, and practice. They enable the teachings to sink deeply into one's understanding. Modern tendencies to remove or abbreviate them often create an impression of terseness that simply does not reflect the original mode of transmission.

In this translation, the repetitions are restored and preserved in full – even when doing so demanded long days, and sometimes weeks, of translation, narration, and transcription, in a dedicated effort to re-link these dismembered and scattered sections of the discourses. In addition, key Pāli terms are retained where necessary, allowing readers to trace meanings accurately, while English renderings convey accessibility and readability.

Here, I feel it is necessary to say a few words about the very rich and ultra-nuanced terms used by The Buddha in His dissemination of The Dhamma.

Although many such terms were used by His contemporaries, such as *dhamma*, *tathāgata*, *vimutti*, *kamma*, *brahmin*, etc., the Great Teacher reintroduced these terms by rendering a thoroughly new and different meaning for each. One such organically and highly contextual Pāli term that The Blessed One used was "*saṅkhāra.*" Here, I have used several definitions for "saṅkhāra" throughout this retranslated work of the Numerical Discourses (as well as in the other collections or Nikāyas), rather than being rigidly bound to a single definition. To this end, readers will discover "*saṅkhāra*" presented as "*habitual drive(s),*" "*generative cause(s),*" "*winding,*" "*preparing*" or "*loading up,*" or "*conditioned.*" Often, however (as with other terms like *Citta* or *Samādhi)*, I have found it essential to simply leave it in its Pāli form, as purely "saṅkhāra." This, because readers are highly encouraged to become familiar with the original Pāli forms of these extremely important terms, given their unique role within The Buddhist Training, instead of using the current familiar and rather limited English definitions for it, i.e. "*formation,*" "*fermentation,*" "*choices,*" etc.

The second principle to which I have adhered in this work is **directness**. The Dhamma of the Nikāyas speaks for itself. It does not require elaborate conceptual scaffolding, philosophical preambles, or densely packed pages of academic framing for its meaning to become evident. Therefore, this Introduction – while providing necessary orientation – deliberately avoids to become another scholarly essay that stands between the reader and The Buddha's words. In recent decades, we have grown accustomed to multi-layered commentary, footnotes, digressions, doctrinal charts, and interpretive debates. Such materials may hold value in certain contexts, yet they risk turning the living Dhamma into an object of intellectual fascination rather than a Path of Practice and True Liberation.

My intention is to gently encourage the reader to step beyond the habit of meeting the Nikāyas through an academic lens alone.

The Buddha did not care to speak to scholars.

He spoke to human beings – farmers, kings, merchants, recluses, artisans, wanderers – people with fears, hopes, questions, and obstacles not unlike our own.

The Dhamma is timeless because it speaks directly, clearly, and compassionately to the very structure of human experience. It is not my place to obscure this directness with layers of theoretical framing. Rather, I strive to allow the suttas to shine through **uninterrupted**, so the reader may meet them as the early Saṅgha did: openly, attentively, and without preconception. This because, the teachings are not bound by time or place; they remain as potent and

transformative today as they were when first spoken, offering a path to liberation for all who engage with them sincerely. So, approach them reflectively, with care and attention, and allow The Dhamma to unfold naturally in your own experience.

Another central dimension of this project has been the recognition, that such an undertaking requires not only scholarly training and linguistic skill, but the **full commitment of monastic life**. Some years ago, I closed my psychotherapy practice as a clinician, and embraced homelessness as a Bhikkhu to devote myself entirely to the preservation and translation of The Buddha's discourses. This was not a romantic or symbolic gesture, but a necessary step. The depth of attention demanded by this work – its precision, continuity, and meditative integrity – could not coexist with professional responsibilities.

This translation exists only because of the generosity of supporters whose faith and kindness have sustained me with the four requisites of a Bhikkhu: food, clothing, shelter, and medicine. Without their help, this task – spanning thousands of pages, countless hours, and multiple continents across the world – would not have been possible. To these individuals, I express my deepest gratitude. And the **merit of preserving The Dhamma** is shared fully and freely with all who have supported and encouraged this effort, and continue to do so.

The Anguttara Nikāya is especially suitable for modern readers. Its structure allows The Dhamma to be entered *at any point* – one may read a single short sutta and carry its teaching through the day, or delve into thematic clusters that illuminate The Path from multiple angles. Its emphasis on gradual cultivation mirrors the lived reality of practice: step by step, quality by quality, choice by choice, moment by moment.

It is my sincere wish that this translation bring the reader into direct contact with the liberating clarity of The Buddha's words. May these teachings be approached with mindfulness and humility, without haste or presumption. And may they serve as a steady light in a world that, like ancient India, is marked by both beauty and confusion, both aspiration and suffering.

Offered freely, without condition, and with a heart dedicated to the continuation of The Buddha's Dispensation, this work is for the benefit of all beings.

Bhikkhu Candana,
Buddhist Era 2569 (2026)

Ekanipāta

–

Book of the Ones

a brief note

The Book of Ones

Ekanipāta



The *Book of Ones* gathers short yet profound teachings centered on single principles that illuminate the essence of The Dhamma. These suttas reveal how *even* one quality – when understood, cultivated, or avoided – can shape the entire course of a person's life. Although brief, these discourses bring to the foreground the foundational themes upon which later teachings build: the importance of wholesome mental qualities, mindfulness, heedfulness, and the consequences of our intentional actions.

Hence, this first book of the Numerical Discourses focuses on single items that have a powerful impact on the mind. It emphasizes the importance of a single "shining" heart/mind, the danger of a single uncontrolled thought, and the value of a single person (The Buddha). In addition, we see the "foremost" disciples being listed, with those Bhikkhus and Bhikkhunis followed by male and female lay disciples, who excelled in one or more specific areas, and as such were singled out by The Blessed One, Himself.

The Buddha here teaches on the *Luminous Heart* (AN 1.41-50), along with the emphasis He places on mindfulness practice that is directed to and fastened onto the body, as shown in the *Kāyagatā Vagga* (AN 575-615), and how it takes one straight to The Deathless, as seen in *Amata Vagga* (AN 616-627).

The *Ones* invite the reader to appreciate the simplicity and directness with which The Buddha spoke, showing that Freedom begins *not* with complexity, but with clarity about even a single thing. Here, one finds a straightforward entry into the nature of mind, behavior, and The Path to Release, that is Nibbāna.



Anguttara Nikāya

The Numerical Discourses

A New Translation

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa

Ekanipāta

Book of the Ones

Suttas 1 - 627

AN I

Suttas 1-10

Rūpādi (Citta Pariyādāna) Vagga

"Section on that which Dominates the Heart"

1.

This is what I personally heard.

At one time, The Blessed One was living in the monastery offered by Anāthapiṇḍika at Jeta's Park, in the City of Sāvatthī. There, The Blessed One addressed the Bhikkhus by saying:

"Bhikkhus!"

"Yes, Blessed Lord!" Those Bhikkhus replied, and The Blessed One continued:

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single form or shape that so utterly dominates the heart of a man, as seeing the form or shape of a woman.

"Truly, nothing captivates a man's heart like the shape and figure of a woman."

2.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single sound or voice that so utterly dominates the heart of a man, as hearing the voice or sound of a woman.

"Truly, nothing captivates a man's heart like the voice or sound of a woman."

3.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single smell or scent that so utterly dominates the heart of a man, as experiencing the scent or smell of a woman.

"Truly, nothing captivates a man's heart like the scent or smell of a woman."

4.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single taste or flavor that so utterly dominates the heart of a man, as experiencing the taste or flavor of a woman.

“Truly, nothing captivates a man’s heart like the taste or flavor of a woman.”

5.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single touch that so utterly dominates the heart of a man, as experiencing the touch of a woman.

“Truly, nothing captivates a man’s heart like the touch of a woman.”

6.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single form or shape that so utterly dominates the heart of a woman, as seeing the form or shape of a man.

“Truly, nothing captivates a woman’s heart like the shape and figure of a man.”

7.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single sound or voice that so utterly dominates the heart of a woman, as hearing the voice or sound of a man.

“Truly, nothing captivates a woman’s heart like the voice or sound of a man.”

8.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single smell or scent that so utterly dominates the heart of a woman, as experiencing the scent or smell of a man.

“Truly, nothing captivates a woman’s heart like the scent or smell of a man.”

9.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single taste or flavor that so utterly dominates the heart of a woman, as experiencing the taste or flavor of a man.

“Truly, nothing captivates a woman’s heart like the taste or flavor of a man.”

10.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single touch that so utterly dominates the heart of a woman, as experiencing the touch of a man.

“Truly, nothing captivates a woman’s heart like the touch of a man.”



AN I

Suttas 11-20

Nīvaraṇappahāna Vagga

"Giving Up the Obstacles"

11.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that is more flammable in its nature, triggering the arising of sensual desires that have not yet arisen, *and* flaring up those sensual desires that have already arisen, than that which bears the quality of attractiveness or being lovely.

"Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever keeps paying unwise attention to whatever bears the quality of being lovely or attractive, will only experience the triggering of sensual desires that were not there, which now arise, *and* the flaring up of the sensual desires that had already arisen."

12.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that is more burning and incendiary in its nature, triggering the arising of anger that has not yet arisen, *and* flaring up the anger that has already arisen in the heart, than that which bears the quality of repulsiveness or being disgusting.

"Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever keeps paying unwise attention to whatever bears the quality of being repulsive or disgusting, will only experience the triggering of anger that was not there, which now arises, *and* the flaring up of the anger that had already arisen."

13.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that is more destructive in its nature, triggering the arising of drowsiness and procrastination that have not yet arisen, *and* flaring up the drowsiness and procrastination that have already arisen in the heart, than that which bears the quality of being discontented, careless, disinterested, lazy, or not wanting to do anything or engage in any work, as in becoming lethargic and sluggish after a heavy meal.

“Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever allows himself to become sluggish and lethargic, will surely experience the triggering of drowsiness and procrastination that were not there, which now arise, *and* the flaring up of the drowsiness and procrastination that have already arisen.”

14.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that is more troublesome in its nature, triggering the arising of restlessness and worry that have not yet arisen, *and* flaring up the restlessness and worrisome thoughts that have already arisen in the heart, than applying unwise attention that agitates the heart.

“Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever allows himself to become agitated in the heart, will only experience the triggering of restlessness and worrisome thoughts that were not there, which now arise, *as well as* the flaring up of restlessness and worrisome thoughts that have already arisen.”

15.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that is more damaging in its nature, triggering the arising of skeptical doubt that has not yet arisen, *and* flaring up the skeptical doubt that has already arisen in the heart, than applying unwise attention.

“Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever applies unwise attention, will only experience the triggering of skeptical doubts that were not there, which now arise, *and* the flaring up of those skeptical doubts that have already arisen.”

16.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that so disrupts and fully stops the arising of sensual desires that have not yet arisen, and causes the abandonment of sensual desires which have already arisen in the heart, than the application of wise radical attention upon that which is ugly and thus bears the quality of repulsiveness.

“Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever applies wise radical attention upon the repulsive, will only experience the stopping of the not yet arisen sensual desires from manifesting, *as well as* the abandonment of sensual desires that have already arisen.”

17.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that so disrupts and fully stops the arising of anger or hostility that has not yet arisen, and causes the abandonment and relinquishing of anger or hostility which has already arisen in the heart, than infusing the heart with *Mettā* (Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness).

"Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever applies wise radical attention by infusing the heart with Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, will only experience the stopping of the not yet arisen anger or hostility from ever arising, as well as the abandonment and relinquishment of anger or hostility that have already arisen."

18.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that so disrupts and obliterates the arising of drowsiness and procrastination that has not yet arisen, and also causes the demolishing and obliteration of drowsiness and procrastination which have already arisen in the heart, than possessing the element of taking initiative, the element of perseverance, and the element of tenacity.

"Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever takes the initiative by continuously exerting himself and with persistence, will only experience the demolishing and obliteration of the not yet arisen drowsiness and procrastination, and thus prevent them from arising, *as well as* the demolishing and obliteration of drowsiness and procrastination that have already arisen."

19.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that so dissipates and fully obliterates the arising of restlessness and worrisome states that have not yet arisen and causes the vanishing and obliteration of restlessness and worrisome states which have already arisen in the heart, than to trustingly reestablish peace and tranquility in the heart.

"Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever trustingly and confidently reestablishes peace and tranquility in one's heart, will only experience the dissipation and obliteration of the not yet arisen restlessness and worrisome states, and thus prevent them from arising, *as well as* the dissipation and obliteration of restlessness and worrisome states that have already arisen."

20.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of even a single thing that so prevents and eliminates the arising of skeptical doubt which has not yet arisen, and evaporates the skeptical doubt that has already arisen in the heart, as the application of wise radical attention.

“Therefore, it is no surprise, Bhikkhus, that whoever trustingly applies wise radical attention, will surely experience the prevention of the not yet arisen skeptical doubts, and thus avert them from arising, as well as the evaporation of skeptical doubt that has already arisen.”



AN I

Suttas 21-30

Akammaniya Vagga

"Section on the Useless"

21.

"Bhikkhus, nothing is as useless as an unruly heart, which remains undeveloped and rigid. This, because the undeveloped heart is truly useless, remaining rigid.

22.

"Bhikkhus, nothing is as adaptable and wieldy as an evolved heart that is malleable. This, because such a developed and transformed heart is truly adaptable and wieldy.

23.

"Bhikkhus, nothing is as devastating and harmful as an unruly heart, which remains undeveloped. This, because the undeveloped heart is truly detrimental and harmful.

24.

"Bhikkhus, nothing is as beneficial and valuable as an evolved heart that is malleable. This, because such a developed and transformed heart is truly beneficial and valuable.

25.

"Bhikkhus, nothing is as wasteful and inefficient as an unevolved heart, which remains untapped. This, because the unevolved heart is truly a waste, leading one to great harm.

26.

“Bhikkhus, nothing brings as many life-changing and great rewards as an evolved heart. This, because the heart that is evolved truly brings many life-changing rewards and benefits.

27.

“Bhikkhus, nothing brings as much harm and devastation as a rigidly uncultivated heart. This, because the uncultivated heart truly brings much harm and devastation.

28.

“Bhikkhus, nothing is as responsible for bringing forth and manifesting much good as a heart that is cultivated and well-trained. This, because the well-trained heart truly is responsible for bringing forth much good.

29.

“Bhikkhus, nothing is as responsible for causing much suffering, as a heart that is uncultivated and untrained. This, because the untrained heart truly is responsible for causing much suffering.

30.

“Bhikkhus, nothing is as responsible for bringing so much happiness, as a heart that is cultivated and trained. This, because the trained heart truly is responsible for bringing much happiness.

AN I

Suttas 31-40

Adanta Vagga

"The Untamed Mind"

31.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much harm and destruction, as an untamed and unrefined mind. For, an untamed mind is truly harmful.

32.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much good and happiness, as a tamed and refined mind. For, a tamed mind is truly beneficial.

33.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much damage and harm, as an uncontrolled mind. For, an uncontrolled mind is truly damaging.

34.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to safety and comfort, as a well-guarded and controlled mind. For, a well-guarded and controlled mind is truly comforting.

35.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much danger, as an unprotected mind. For, an unprotected mind is truly dangerous.

36.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so many great outcomes, as a protected mind. For, a protected mind truly brings about much good.

37.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much pain and harm, as an unrestrained mind. For, an unrestrained mind is truly painful.

38.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much soothing comfort and ease, as a restrained mind. For, a restrained mind is truly soothing.

39.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much harm as an untamed, unguarded, uncontrolled, unprotected, and unrestrained mind. For, a mind that is untamed, unguarded, uncontrolled, unprotected, and unrestrained is truly harmful.

40.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that leads to so much happiness and ease, as a mind that is tamed, guarded, controlled, protected, and restrained. For, a mind that is tamed, guarded, controlled, protected, and restrained is truly beneficial, as it brings much good.”



AN I

Suttas 41-50

Paṇihita Accha Vagga

"Pointed in the Right Direction"

41.

"Bhikkhus, so long as a man does not carelessly step on nor incorrectly handle a rake used for breaking and sorting rice or barley, he will not inflict any harm upon himself, whether by cutting his skin or hurting himself, thus not causing blood to ooze out.

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because the sharp claws of the rake are all pointed in the right direction.

"Conversely, Bhikkhus, so long as the Bhikkhu is careless about which direction his heart is pointed, having misplaced his attention, then, as a result, he will not penetrate through ignorance nor gain the higher understanding of Truth. Therefore, it is impossible for such a Bhikkhu to ever come close to the realization of Nibbāna.

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because his heart is pointed in the *wrong* direction."

42.

"Bhikkhus, so long as a man carelessly steps on or incorrectly handles a rake used for breaking and sorting rice or barley, he will then surely inflict harm upon himself by cutting his skin and hurting himself, whereby blood would be oozing out.

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because the sharp claws of the rake are all pointed in the wrong direction.

"Conversely, Bhikkhus, so long as the Bhikkhu is careful about which direction his heart is pointed, having correctly placed his attention, then, as a result, he *will* penetrate through ignorance and gain the higher understanding of Truth. Therefore, it is possible for such a Bhikkhu to attain the realization of Nibbāna.

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because his heart is pointed in the *right* direction."

43.

"Bhikkhus, as I penetrate the heart of another person with my heart, and see it to be corrupted, I then declare:

'If this person were to die at this moment, he will certainly be reborn in hell, as though he is dragged and dropped there, instantaneously, as a result of him having such a defiled heart.'

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because his heart is corrupted.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is on account of living with corrupted hearts that beings, right at that moment of death, when their bodies have broken down, are instantaneously reborn into states of misery, experiencing terrible pain and anguish, within the hell realms."

44.

"Bhikkhus, as I penetrate the heart of another person with my heart, and see it to be purified, I then declare:

'If this person were to die at this moment, he will certainly be reborn in the heavenly realms, as though rushed there, instantaneously, as a result of him having such a purified heart.'

"And what is the reason for this?

"It is because his heart is pure and clean.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is on account of living with purified hearts that beings, right at that moment of death, when their bodies have broken down, are instantaneously reborn into states of pleasure and delight, experiencing unimaginable happiness and ease, within the divine realms."

45.

"Imagine, Bhikkhus, a stirred up, murky, and clouded lake, which had within it many schools of fish swimming about, along with the pebbles and rocks at its bottom, as well as the plant life

living beneath it. Meanwhile, there was a man standing on its shore, who kept looking down into the water, but was unable to see even a single thing.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the lake is, in fact, murky and very clouded.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, when the Bhikkhu has a heart that is clouded with defilements, they obstruct him from either knowing or understanding as to what is truly beneficial for him or serves him best. He would not know nor understand as to what is truly beneficial to others either, or what may serve them best. Furthermore, he would not know or understand as to what is truly beneficial to both himself and others, or what may best serve them both, either. But especially, that Bhikkhu would not see things as they truly are by not being able to realize it for himself, with the knowledge and vision that is a quality of the Noble Ones.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because such a Bhikkhu has a heart that is clouded with defilements.”

46.

“Imagine, Bhikkhus, a crystal clear and unperturbed lake, which had within it many schools of fish swimming about, along with the pebbles and rocks at its bottom that remained clearly visible, as well as the plant life living beneath it. Meanwhile, there was a man standing on its shore, looking down, who was able to see all that was taking place within the lake itself.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the lake is, in fact, crystal clear and unperturbed.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, when the Bhikkhu has a heart that is purified and free from the defilements, he is thus able to know and understand as to what is truly beneficial for him or serves him best. In addition, he would also know and understand as to what is truly beneficial for others as well, and what may serve them best. Furthermore, he would know and understand as to what is truly beneficial for both himself and others, as well as what may best serve them both. Especially, however, that Bhikkhu would come to see things as they truly are, by realizing it for himself, with knowledge and vision, which is a quality of the Noble Ones.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because such a Bhikkhu has a heart that is crystal clear and unperturbed.”

47.

“Bhikkhus, among all trees that are pliable and wieldy, the sandalwood is the chief, given its softness and adaptability to pressure and pliability.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is as adaptable in its pliability as the mind, once it is properly developed and disciplined. This, because the well-developed mind that is properly disciplined, is indeed pliable and wieldy.”

48.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that changes ever so quickly, as does the mind. In fact, it is quite difficult to adequately demonstrate, even through the use of similes, the rapidly changing nature of the mind.”

49.

“Luminously radiant, Bhikkhus, is the heart. However, it becomes spoiled by the suffocating entrapment of the corrupting defilements.”

50.

“Luminously radiant, Bhikkhus, is the heart. And, it can surely be released from the suffocating entrapment of the defilements.”

AN I

Suttas 51-60

Accharāsaṅghāta Vagga

"The Snap of a Finger"

51.

"Luminously radiant, Bhikkhus, is the heart. However, it becomes spoiled by the suffocating encroachment of the corrupting defilements.

"This, the untrained ordinary dense person (*putujjana*) does not know as it really is, and because of this reason, I declare that for such an untrained ordinary dense person, there can be no development of the heart."

52.

"Luminously radiant, Bhikkhus, is the heart. And, it is released from the suffocating encroachment of the defilements."

"This, the Noble Disciple (*Ariya Sāvaka*) does know as it really is, and because of this reason, I declare that for such a Noble Disciple, there most certainly is development of the heart."

53.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and radiate Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness (*Mettā*) even for a snap of a finger, he is then to be declared 'a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher.' Thus, he would be blamelessly and rightfully partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore, not be blameworthy at all, in partaking of and using all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about a Bhikkhu who pursues Mettā for only a small fraction of time, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu who is fully dedicated and immersed into the practice of Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, throughout his entire life?"

54.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to work on developing Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness (Mettā) even for just a snap of a finger, he is to be declared 'a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna,* living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher.' Thus, he would be blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy at all, in using or consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about a Bhikkhu who cultivates Mettā for such a small fraction of time, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the cultivation of Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, throughout his entire life?"

55.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to stay with and continue on permeating Mettā in his heart, even for just a snap of a finger, he is to be declared 'a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher.' Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be considered blameworthy at all, in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about a Bhikkhu who shines genuine Mettā from his heart for such a small fraction of time, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated to and immersed in suffusing and permeating Mettā, throughout his entire life?"

56.

"Bhikkhus, whatever you are to witness in life, all those phenomena that are damaging, harmful, evil and unwholesome, they all stem from and are led by none other than the mind.

"Therefore, mind with its very intentions is their chief, dictating whatever is to come next, trailing right behind and following it, obediently."

57.

"Bhikkhus, whatever you are to witness in life, all those phenomena that are helpful, beneficial, good and wholesome, they all stem from and are led by none other than the mind.

"Therefore, mind with its very intentions is their chief, dictating whatever is to come next, trailing right behind and following it, obediently."

58.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing more damaging than careless neglect which causes the arising of evil and damaging states that were absent, while at the same time, obliterating all the good qualities of the heart that had already arisen and were present, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

“Therefore, by living an intoxicated life with careless neglect, your damaging qualities will increase, while your beneficial ones will dwindle and disappear.”

59.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing more helpful than heedful attentiveness, which causes the arising of good and beneficial states that were absent, while at the same time, obliterating all the evil qualities of the heart that had already arisen and were present, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

“Therefore, by living an attentive life with diligence, your beneficial qualities will increase, while your damaging ones will dwindle and disappear.”

60.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging than laziness, which causes the arising of evil and damaging states that were absent, while at the same time, obliterating all the good qualities of the heart that had already arisen and were present, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

“Therefore, by living a lazy life, your harmful and evil qualities will only increase and multiply, while your beneficial ones will dwindle and die.”



AN I

Suttas 61-70

Vīriyārambhādi Vagga

"The Section on Arousing Energy"

61.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more effective than mustering up persevering energy within oneself, which causes the arising of good and beneficial (*kusala*) states that were once absent, while at the same time, obliterating all the evil qualities of the heart that were arisen and present, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, living with persevering energy in your heart will only increase your beneficial qualities, while obliterating the damaging ones."

62.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more insidious than possessing the longing for many things, which causes the arising of evil and damaging (*akusala*) states that were absent, while at the same time, abolishing the good qualities of the heart that had already arisen and were present, by pushing them all away, into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, as you live while longing for many things, your harmful and evil qualities will increase, while your beneficial ones will dwindle and disappear."

63.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more effective than having fewness of wishes, which causes the arising of good and beneficial states that were absent, while at the same time, dispelling all the evil qualities of the heart that had arisen.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, living with fewness of wishes in your heart will only increase your beneficial qualities, while obliterating the damaging ones."

64.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more treacherous than being discontented, which causes the arising of evil and damaging states that were absent, while at the same time, pushing out all the good and beneficial qualities from the heart, which had been present.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, living while lacking contentment in your heart will only increase your damaging and evil qualities, while obliterating all the beneficial ones.”

65.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more richly successful than having contentment in one’s heart, which causes the arising of good and beneficial states that were once absent within, while at the same time, dispelling all the evil and damaging qualities from the heart, which had been present.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, living with contentment in your heart will only increase your beneficial qualities, while obliterating the damaging ones.”

66.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more dangerous than being led by unwise and wrong attention (*ayoniso manasikāra*), which causes the arising of evil and damaging states that were once absent, while at the same time, getting rid of the good and beneficial qualities of the heart that were already present, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, as you live while being guided by unwise attention, you will only see your harmful and evil qualities increase, meanwhile your beneficial ones will continuously dwindle and disappear.”

67.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing more valuable than being led by wise radical attention (*yoniso manasikāra*), which causes the arising of good and beneficial states that were once absent, while at the same time, getting rid of the evil and damaging qualities that had arisen in the heart, by pushing them away, into oblivion.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, as you live while being guided by wise radical attention, you will only see your good and beneficial qualities increase, whereas your harmful, evil, and damaging ones, will become obliterated and disappear.”

68.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more perilous than not having full awareness (*asampajañña*), as a result of which evil and damaging states that were once absent suddenly appear and proliferate, while at the same time, the once present good and beneficial qualities of the heart disappear into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, if you live while lacking in full awareness, then you will only see your harmful and evil qualities increase, whereas your beneficial ones will vanish and disappear."

69.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing more protective than possessing full awareness (*sampajañña*), as a result of which good and beneficial states that were once absent suddenly appear and brighten up one's life, while at the same time, the once present evil and damaging qualities of the heart disappear into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, if you live while possessing full awareness, then you will surely see your good and beneficial qualities increase, whereas your harmful, evil, and damaging ones will simply vanish and disappear."

70.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging than having or associating with bad friends, as a result of which evil and damaging states that were once absent, will surely arise, while at the same time, any arisen good or beneficial qualities of the heart that were present at one point, will be pushed away into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, living or associating with bad friends, will lead to damaging, harmful, and evil qualities to increase in you, whereas any present or already arisen good and beneficial qualities will simply die and disappear."

AN I

Suttas 71-81

Kalyāṇamittādi Vagga

"Genuinely Good Spiritual Friends"

71.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more healing than having and associating with genuinely good spiritual friends, as a result of which good and beneficial states that were once absent, surely arise and support one's growth, while at the same time, any arisen evil or damaging qualities of the heart that were present at one point, are destroyed and thrown into oblivion.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, living with or associating with genuinely good spiritual friends, will lead to beneficial and good qualities to increase in you, whereas any present or already arisen evil or damaging qualities will simply die and disappear."

72.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more detrimental than the desire and pursuit of bad habits, while at the same time being disinterested in growth and indifferent to even adopting good habits. Because of such tendencies, evil and damaging states that were once absent will arise, while at the same time, any good or beneficial qualities that may have been present in the heart, will disappear and be no more.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, by living a life where there is the pursuit of bad habits, and indifference towards developing any good habits, you will only see your harmful and evil qualities increase, as your beneficial ones continuously dwindle and disappear."

73.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more constructive than the desire and pursuit of good habits, while at the same time being disinterested in and indifferent to adopting evil habits. Because of such tendencies, good and beneficial states that were once absent will arise,

while at the same time, any evil and damaging qualities that may have been present in the heart, all those will disappear and be no more.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by living a life where there is the pursuit of good habits, and indifference towards developing any bad and evil habits, you will only see your good and beneficial qualities increase, as your harmful, evil, and damaging ones become obliterated and disappear.”

74.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more sinister than possessing unwise or wrong attention, as a result of which the Factors of Awakening that may have not yet arisen, will never get the opportunity to awaken and grow, let alone become fully developed or reach their fullest potential of accomplishment, thus remaining unripe and undeveloped.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by living with unwise and wrong attention, the unarisen Factors of Awakening will remain dormant and never come to their full development or fruition.”

75.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more formidable than possessing wise radical attention, as a result of which the Factors of Awakening that may have not yet arisen, will awaken and grow exponentially, and thus come to be fully developed and reach their potential of accomplishment.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by living with wise radical attention, the unarisen Factors of Awakening will *surely* come to their full development and fruition.”

76.

“Losing relatives is ultimately meaningless, Bhikkhus. For, to live without your loved ones is nothing compared to living without wisdom.”

77.

“Having many relatives is ultimately meaningless, Bhikkhus. What you should strive to increase is *not* the number of relatives to call your ‘own kin,’ but instead, you should strive to increase your wisdom!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should focus all your energy on increasing the wisdom in your heart! That is how you must train yourselves!”

78.

“Losing wealth and all that one possessed is meaningless, Bhikkhus. For, to live without your wealth is nothing compared to living without wisdom.”

79.

“Having much wealth is ultimately meaningless, Bhikkhus. What you should strive to increase is not the size of your riches, properties, or possessions, but your wisdom!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should focus all your energy on increasing the wisdom in your heart! That is how you must train yourselves!”

80.

“Losing your renown or fame is meaningless, Bhikkhus. For, to live without fame is nothing compared to living without wisdom.”

81.

“Having much renown or fame is meaningless, Bhikkhus. What you should strive to increase is *not* your fame, how well you are known, or the popularity you possess. Instead, you should strive to increase your wisdom!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should focus all your energy on increasing the wisdom in your heart! That is how you must train yourselves!”



AN I

Suttas 82-97

Paṭhama Pamādādi Vagga

"On Careless Neglect – Part 1"

82.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more insidious while causing so much harm, than living with careless neglect.

"Careless neglect truly will bring you much harm."

83.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more beneficial while causing so much good, than living with careful vigilance.

"Careful vigilance truly will bring you much good."

84.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging while causing so much harm, than being lazy.

"Laziness truly will bring you much harm."

85.

"Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more beneficial and productive while causing so much good, than striving with persevering effort.

"Persevering effort truly will bring you much good."

86.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more detrimental while causing so much harm, than yearning for so many things.

“Yearning for so many things truly will bring you much harm.”

87.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more beneficial while causing so much good, than having fewness of wishes in one’s heart.

“Possessing fewness of wishes in your heart will truly bring you much good.”

88.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging while causing so much harm, than possessing discontentment in one’s heart.

“Not being contented in your heart will truly bring you much harm, Bhikkhus.”

89.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more advantageous while causing so much good, than possessing contentment in one’s heart.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, dwelling contented in your hearts will truly bring you much good.”

90.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more dangerous while causing so much damage, than living with unwise attention.

“Applying unwise attention in your life will truly bring you much harm.”

91.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more helpful while causing so much good, than living with wise radical attention (*yoniso manasikāra*).

“Applying wise radical attention in your life will truly bring you much good.”

92.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more treacherous while causing so much harm, than living without full awareness.

“Living without full awareness will truly bring you much harm.”

93.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more advantageous while causing so much good, than living with full awareness.

“Living with full awareness will truly bring you much good.”

94.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more destructive while causing so much harm, than associating with and having bad friends in one’s life.

“Associating with and having bad friends will truly bring you much harm.”

95.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more supportive while causing so much good, than associating with and having good spiritual friends.

“Associating with and having good spiritual friends will truly bring you much good.”

96.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more detrimental while causing so much harm, than having the desire for and the pursuit of bad and damaging habits.

“Having the desire for and the pursuit of bad and damaging habits will truly bring you much harm.”

97.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more constructive while causing so much good, than having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits.

“Having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits will truly bring you much good.”



AN I

Suttas 98-139

Dutiya Pamādādi Vagga

"On Careless Neglect – Part 2"

98.

"Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more insidious in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living with careless neglect.

"For truly, careless neglect brings you much harm."

99.

"Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more beneficial in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with careful vigilance.

"For truly, careful vigilance brings you much good."

100.

"Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living with laziness.

"For truly, laziness brings you much harm."

101.

"Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more productive in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with persevering effort.

“For truly, persevering effort brings you much good.”

102.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more detrimental in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living with the yearning for many things.

“For truly, yearning for many things brings you much harm.”

103.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more beneficial in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with fewness of desires.

“For truly, living with fewness of desires brings you much good.”

104.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living with discontent.

“For truly, lacking gratitude or contentment in your heart brings you much harm.”

105.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more advantageous in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with contentment.

“For truly, living with gratitude and contentment in your heart brings you much good.”

106.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more dangerous in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living with unwise and wrong attention.

“For truly, living with unwise and wrong attention brings you much harm.”

107.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more advantageous in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with wise radical attention.

“For truly, living with wise radical attention brings you much good.”

108.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more treacherous in the amount of harm it inflicts, than living without full awareness.

“For truly, living without full awareness brings you much harm.”

109.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more valuable in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than living with full awareness.

“For truly, living with full awareness brings you much good.”

110.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the external factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more destructive in the amount of harm it inflicts, than associating with and having bad friends.

“For truly, associating with and having bad friends in your life brings you much harm.”

111.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the external factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more supportive in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than associating with and having genuinely good spiritual friends.

“For truly, associating with and having genuinely good spiritual friends brings you much good.”

112.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more detrimental in the amount of harm it inflicts, than having the desire for and the pursuit of evil and damaging habits.

“For truly, having the desire for and the pursuit of evil and damaging habits brings you much harm.”

113.

“Bhikkhus, while considering the internal factors that impel or drive a person, I do not know of a single thing that is more constructive in the amount of good it brings to oneself, than having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits.

“For truly, having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits brings you much good.”

114.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living without heedfulness, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainties in the hearts and minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living without heedfulness, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

115.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with heedfulness, as a result of which the essence of the Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of beings, who then come to even attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with heedfulness, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

116.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living with laziness, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainties in the minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with laziness, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

117.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with persevering effort, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty about The Dhamma, and beings attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with persevering effort, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will keep flourishing.”

118.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living with the yearning for many things, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with yearning and desire for many things, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

119.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with the fewness of desires, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, as they attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with fewness of desires, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

120.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to this Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration while hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living with discontentment in the heart, as a result of which distortions of the Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with discontent, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

121.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with contentment in the heart, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, and beings attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with contentment, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

122.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more harmful to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living with unwise and wrong attention, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with unwise and wrong attention, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

123.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more supportive of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with wise radical attention, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, and beings attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with wise radical attention, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

124.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and hastening its inevitable disappearance, than living without full awareness, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living without full awareness, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

125.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than living with full awareness, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, and beings attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of living with full awareness, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

126.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more damaging to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance, than associating with and having bad friends in one’s life, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of associating with and having bad friends in one’s life, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

127.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more protective of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than associating with and having genuinely good spiritual friends in one’s life, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, and beings will continue to attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of associating with and having genuinely good spiritual friends in one’s life, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

128.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more harmful to This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, leading to its rapid demise while hastening its inevitable disappearance, than having the desire for and the pursuit of bad and damaging habits, as a result of which distortions of The Teachings arise, creating confusion and uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of having the desire for and the pursuit of bad and damaging habits, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will degenerate and disappear.”

129.

“But, Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more supportive of this Beautiful and Good Dhamma, promoting its healthy continuity, non-degeneration and its non-disappearance, than having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits, as a result of which the essence of The Teachings is kept alive and undeterred, where there is no confusion or uncertainty in the hearts and minds of people about The Dhamma, and beings attain Its highest Fruits.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of having the desire for and the pursuit of good and beneficial habits, This Beautiful and Good Dhamma will continue to thrive, and those who taste Its Fruits will continue to flourish.”

130.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what is adhamma as Dhamma, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of many

others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma."

131.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what is The Dhamma as adhamma, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just *their* own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, while leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma."

132.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain that which has nothing to do with the Vinaya and The Training as "Vinaya and The Training," are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma."

133.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what is in fact The Vinaya and The Training itself, as neither being The Vinaya nor The Training, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

134.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what has been *neither* declared *nor* taught by The Tathāgata as having been declared and taught by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of this Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

135.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what *has* indeed been declared and taught by The Tathāgata as not having been declared and taught by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and harm onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

136.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what has *not* been practiced by The Tathāgata as having been practiced by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

137.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what *has* indeed been practiced by The Tathāgata as not having been practiced by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

138.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what has *not* been prescribed by The Tathāgata as having been prescribed by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

139.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what *has* indeed been prescribed by The Tathāgata as not having been prescribed by The Tathāgata, are not just harming themselves, but bringing much harm and pain onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results *not* just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery *not* just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”



AN I

Suttas 140-149

Adhamma Vagga

"What is non-Dhamma"

140.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is adhamma *as* adhamma, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time."

141.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what *is* in fact Dhamma as Dhamma, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time."

142.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is *not* The Vinaya nor The Training as in fact, *not* The Vinaya nor The Training, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

143.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what *is* The Vinaya and The Training as in fact, The Vinaya and The Training, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others; bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

144.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what has *not* been declared by The Tathāgata as indeed, that which has *not* been declared nor taught by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

145.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what *has* indeed been declared by The Tathāgata as having been declared and taught by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

146.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what has *not* been practiced by The Tathāgata as not having been practiced by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

147.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what *has* indeed been practiced by The Tathāgata as having been practiced by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

148.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what has *not* been prescribed by The Tathāgata as indeed *not* having been prescribed by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”

149.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what *has* been prescribed by The Tathāgata as indeed having been prescribed by The Tathāgata, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all other beings, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance, for a long time.”



AN I

Suttas 150-169

Anāpatti Vagga

"Not an Offence"

150.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who explain what is not an offense as an offense, are not just harming themselves, but are bringing such pain and harm onto so many others as well, causing the suffering of so many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma."

151.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what is really an offense, but explain it away as not being an offense, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma."

152.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what is really a minor offense, but explain it as being a seriously grave offense, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto

so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

153.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what is really a seriously grave offense but explain it away as being only a minor offense, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

154.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what is really a wicked and evil-intentioned offense but explain it as neither being a wicked nor an evil-intentioned offense, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

155.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what really is not a wicked or evil-intentioned offense at all but explain it as being a wicked and evil-intentioned offense, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In

doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

156.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what is really an offense that can be easily remedied, but explain it as not being an offense that can be remedied at all, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

157.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what, in fact, is an offense that cannot be remedied, but explain it as being an offense that can be remedied, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

158.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at what, in fact, is an offense that needs to be made right and properly dealt with, but explain it as an offense that neither is to be made right nor properly dealt with, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and

damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

159.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who look at an offense that need not be made right nor properly dealt with but explain it as an offense that needs to be made right and properly dealt with, are not just harming themselves, but bringing such pain and harm onto so many others, causing the suffering of many people. In doing so, they are ruining not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, creating misfortune and miserable merit-making and damaging results not just to their own detriment, but to the detriment of all others, both Devas and humans.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing harm and misery not just to themselves, but to countless others, leading to the rapid degeneration and inevitable disappearance of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma.”

160.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is not an offense as not being an offense, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance.”

161.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is an offense as being in fact an offense, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."

162.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is a minor offense, as being just that – a minor offense, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."

163.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is a seriously grave offense as, in fact, a seriously grave offense, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."

164.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is a wicked and evil-intentioned offense, as being just that – a wicked and evil-intentioned offense, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance.”

165.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what is not really a wicked and evil-intentioned offense, as not being a wicked and evil-intentioned offense, are behaving in a way where they are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others; protecting the wellbeing of so many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others; bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, to both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus, are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the healthy and flourishing continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance.”

166.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is an offense that can be easily remedied, as being just that –an offense that can be easily remedied, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

“Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance.”

167.

“Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is not an offense that can be easily remedied, as not being an offense that can be easily remedied, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."

168.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is an offense that needs to be made right and properly dealt with, as being just that – an offense that needs to be made right and properly dealt with, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."

169.

"Bhikkhus, those Bhikkhus who truly explain what really is not an offense that needs to be made right or properly dealt with, as not being an offense that needs to be made right or properly dealt with, are benefitting both themselves and others, for they are bringing such happiness and comfort onto so many others, protecting the wellbeing of many people. In doing so, they are enriching not just their own lives, but the lives of so many others, bringing good fortune and bright merit-making and beneficial results of such wonderful actions not just to themselves, but to all others, both Devas and humans combined.

"Therefore, these Bhikkhus are bringing safety and happiness not just to themselves, but to countless others, promoting the flourishing and continuity of This Beautiful and Good Dhamma, by ensuring its non-degeneration and non-disappearance."



AN I

Suttas 170-187

Ekapuggala Vagga

"The One Person"

170.

"There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, who appears in this world; born for the welfare and happiness of both Devas and humans.

"And who is That Person?

"That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans."

171.

"There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, whose appearance in existence is so very rare.

"And who is That Person?

"That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans."

172.

"There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, who is truly exceptional beyond compare, appearing in this world.

"And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

173.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, whose loss is mourned and lamented over by countless beings throughout the cosmos.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

174.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, who is peerless and without a rival, unimaginably one-of-a-kind, incomparable, matchless, and without an equal throughout existence, The One who is indeed The Chief among all bipeds.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

175.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, there also occurs the appearance of All-Penetrating True Vision.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

176.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, there also occurs the appearance of The All-Penetrating True Light.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

177.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, there also occurs the appearance of His Unmatched Brilliant Radiance.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

178.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, there also occurs the appearance of The Six Peerless Qualities.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

179.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, the Mastery of the Four Analytical Knowledges suddenly becomes possible to attain.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

180.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, the penetration into the innumerable elements suddenly becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

181.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, penetrating the countless diversity of phenomena throughout existence, suddenly becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

182.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, suddenly, the attainment of The Fruit of True Knowledge and Release, finally becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

183.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, suddenly, the attainment of the Fruit of Stream Winning, finally becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

184.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, suddenly, the attainment of the Fruit of Once-Returning, finally becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

185.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, suddenly, the attainment of the Fruit of Non-Returning, finally becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

186.

“There is that One Person, Bhikkhus, because of whose appearance into existence, suddenly, the attainment of the Fruit of Arahanthood, finally becomes possible.

“And who is That Person?

“That Person, Bhikkhus, is none other than The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Self-Awakened One, who willfully arises in the world, driven by the Great Compassion He has for the wellbeing, the good, the welfare, and happiness of all beings, both Devas and humans.”

187.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of any person throughout existence, who is able to maintain and keep turning This Matchless Wheel of Dhamma, set in motion by The Tathāgata, as does Sāriputta!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, Sāriputta truly keeps maintaining This Matchless Wheel of Dhamma, that was set in motion by The Tathāgata.”



AN I

Suttas 188-267

Etadagga Vagga

"The Chief – From Each Category"

188.

"Bhikkhus, the most senior among all My Bhikkhu disciples is "Koṇḍañña Who Understood," for he was the first among you to attain.

189.

"Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples with great wisdom, Sāriputta is their chief.

190.

"Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples wielding mighty psychic powers, Mahāmoggallāna is their chief.

191.

"Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who observe and live the ascetic life, Mahākassapa is their chief.

192.

"Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who possess the Divine Eye, Anuruddha is their chief.

193.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who have gone forth from eminent families, Bhaddiya Kāḷīgodhā is their chief.

194.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who possess a sweet voice, Bhaddiya Lakuṇḍaka (the Dwarf) is their chief.

195.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples with the Lion’s Roar, Piṇḍola Bhāradvāja is their chief.

196.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who give discourses on The Dhamma, Puṇṇa Mantāṇīputta is their chief.

197.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who explain The Dhamma in great detail, Mahākaccāna is their chief.”

Dutiya Vagga

The Second Sub Group

198.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who can create a mind-made body, Cūḷapanthaka is their chief.”

199.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who can rapidly evolve and beneficially transform their mind, Cūḷapanthaka is their chief.”

200.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who can beneficially transform their perceptions, Mahāpanthaka is their chief.”

201.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who live without any conflicts, Subhūti is their chief.”

202.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are worthy of offerings, Subhūti is their chief.”

203.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who dwell in remote wilderness and forest areas, Revata Khadiravaniya is their chief.”

204.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who attain to and dwell in *jhāna*, Kaṅkhārevata is their chief.”

205.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who put forth fervent effort, Soṇa Koḷivisa is their chief.”

206.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who use speech that is lovely and sweet, Soṇa Kuṭikaṇṇa is their chief.”

207.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who receive abundance of gifts, Sīvali is their chief.”

208.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who attain Release through their strong faith, Vakkalī is their chief.”

Tatiya Vagga

The Third Sub Group

209.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples in their eagerness to learn, who desire The Training, Rāhula is their chief.”

210.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who go forth out of their strong faith, Raṭṭhapāla is their chief.”

211.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who receive the first assigned morsels of food, Kuṇḍadhāna is their chief.”

212.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who, in being inspired by The Dhamma, make poetic expressions, Vaṅgīsa is their chief.”

213.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are inspiring in their friendliness towards everyone, Upasena Vaṅgantāputta is their chief.”

214.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who assign a place for visiting Bhikkhus to stay at, Dabba Mallaputta is their chief.”

215.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are beloved and adored by the Devas, Pilindavaccha is their chief.”

216.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who attain to Direct Knowledge and Higher Understanding the fastest and instantaneously, Bāhiya Dārucīrya is their chief.”

217.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are dynamically resourceful in their use of speech, applying a diverse set of similes while explaining The Dhamma, Kumāra Kassapa is their chief.”

218.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who attain the Mastery of the Four Analytical Knowledges, Mahākoṭṭhita is their chief.

Catuttha Vagga

The Fourth Sub Group

219.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are very learned in The Dhamma, Ānanda is their chief.”

220.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who possess impeccable memory, Ānanda is their chief.”

221.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who quickly understand, Ānanda is their chief.”

222.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are resolute and steadfast, Ānanda is their chief.”

223.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who attend on others, carefully as they serve, Ānanda is their chief.”

224.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who have large groups of followers, Uruvelā Kassapa is their chief.”

225.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who inspire trust and confidence in householders, Kāḷudāyī is their chief.”

226.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who possess good health, Bakkula is their chief.”

227.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who recollect their countless previous lives in detail, Sobhita is their chief.”

228.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who uphold and are experts at The Vinaya rules of Discipline for monastics, Upāli is their chief.”

229.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who instruct and teach The Dhamma to the Bhikkhunis, Nandaka is their chief.”

230.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who guard all the sense doors, Nanda is their chief.”

231.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who instruct and teach The Dhamma to the Bhikkhus, Mahākappina is their chief.”

232.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who are masters at attaining to the Fire Element, Sāgata is their chief.”

233.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who ask the type of questions that lead to inspiring Dhamma discourses, Rādha is their chief.”

234.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhu disciples who wear rough and coarse robes, Mogharājā is their chief.”

Pañcama Vagga

The Fifth Sub Group

235.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples, Mahāpajāpati Gotamī is their chief.”

236.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who possess great wisdom, Khemā is their chief.”

237.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who possess psychic powers, Uppalavāṇṇā is their chief.”

238.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who uphold and are experts at The Vinaya rules of Discipline for monastics, Paṭācārā is their chief.”

239.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who are experts at giving Dhamma discourses, Dhammadinnā is their chief.”

240.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who attain to and dwell in *jhāna*, Nandā is their chief.”

241.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who put forth fervent effort, Soṇā is their chief.”

242.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who possess the Divine Eye, Sakulā is their chief.”

243.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who attain to Direct Knowledge and Higher Understanding the quickest, Bhaddā Kuṇḍalakesā is their chief.”

244.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who recollect their countless previous lives in detail, Bhaddā Kāpilānī is their chief.”

245.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who attain to the Highest Knowledge along with the Great Abilities, Bhaddākaccānā is their chief.”

246.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who wear rough and coarse robes, Kisāgotamī is their chief.”

247.

“Bhikkhus, among all My Bhikkhuni disciples who possess unshakable faith and confidence, Siṅgālakamātā is their chief.”

Chaṭṭha Vagga

The Sixth Sub Group

248.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples (*Upāsakas*) who take Refuge, the two brother merchants, Tapussa and Bhallika, are their chiefs, for they were the very first.”

249.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who stand out in their boundless generosity, the householder Sudatta Anāthapiṇḍika is their chief.”

250.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who excel in their ability to explain The Dhamma exquisitely, the householder Citta Macchikāsaṇḍika is their chief.”

251.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who are beloved by the Sangha in their ability to live with open-handed generosity, their use of kind speech, in serving others and being equanimous in their relationship with others, Hatthaka of Āḷavī is their chief.”

252.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who generously provide the best of all that they offer to the Sangha, Mahānāma the Sākyan is their chief.”

253.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who are pleasant and lovely in offering whatever is necessary to the Sangha, Ugga of Vesālī is their chief.”

254.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples who serve and attend to the needs of the Sangha, the householder Uggata of Hatthigāma is their chief.”

255.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples with unassailable confidence in The Dhamma, through wisdom, the householder Sūrambaṭṭha is their chief.”

256.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples, who genuinely trust by placing their confidence in a person, Jīvaka Komārabhacca is their chief.”

257.

“Bhikkhus, among all My male lay disciples, who are trustworthy confidants, the householder Nakulapitā is their chief.”

Sattama Vagga

The Seventh Sub Group

258.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples (*Upāsikās*) who take Refuge, Sujātā, the daughter of Senānī, is their chief, for she was the very first.”

259.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who stand out in their boundless generosity, the householder Visākhā, ‘Migāra’s Mother,’ is their chief.”

260.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who are exceedingly learned in The Dhamma, Khujjuttarā is their chief.”

261.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples, who live and breathe with Mettā, Sāmāvatī is their chief.”

262.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who attain to and dwell in *jhāna,* Uttarānandamātā is their chief.”

263.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who generously provide the best of all that they offer to the Sangha, Suppavāsā the Koliyan daughter is their chief.”

264.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who attend to the sick, Suppiyā is their chief.”

265.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples with unassailable confidence in The Dhamma, through wisdom, Kātiyānī is their chief.”

266.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who are trustworthy confidants, the householder Nakulamātā is their chief.”

267.

“Bhikkhus, among all My female lay disciples who gain unshakable confidence in The Tathāgata simply by hearing others speak, Kāḷī of Kuraraghara is their chief.”

AN I

Suttas 268-295

Aṭṭhānapali Vagga

"The Impossibilities"

Paṭhama Vagga

The First Sub Group

268.

"Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever look upon anything that is put together and thus conditioned (*saṅkhārā*), and yet continue to take it as something permanent. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

"However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person should look upon things that are put together and conditioned (*saṅkhārā*), and see them as permanent. There is the possibility for this to occur."

269.

"Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever look upon anything that is put together and thus conditioned (*saṅkhārā*), and yet continue to believe that it could be truly pleasurable and satisfying. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

"However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person should look upon things that are put together and conditioned (*saṅkhārā*), and see them as truly pleasurable and satisfying. There is the possibility for this to occur."

270.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever look upon anything and see it as having a substantial essence or selfhood. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person should look upon things and see them as truly having a substantial essence or selfhood. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

271.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever murder or take the life of his own mother. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could murder or take the life of his mother. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

272.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever murder or take the life of his own father. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could murder or take the life of his father. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

273.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever murder or take the life of an Arahant. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could murder or take the life of an Arahant. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

274.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever injure or shed the blood of The Tathāgata, with evil intent. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could injure or shed the blood of The Tathāgata, with evil intent. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

275.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever try and maliciously create a division within The Sangha. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could try and maliciously create a division within The Sangha. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

276.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for someone who has finally attained to Right View, to ever acknowledge someone other than The Tathāgata as the True Teacher. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible that an ordinary unlearned person could acknowledge someone other than The Tathāgata as the True Teacher. There is the possibility for this to occur.”

277.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible that, somehow, there could be two Arahants, Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddhas, appearing in the same world system, at the same time. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a single Arahant, a Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddha to appear in a world system. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

Dutiya Vagga

The Second Sub Group

278.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that there could be two Wheel-Turning Universal Monarchs (*Cakkavattins*) appearing in the same world system, at the same time. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a single Wheel-Turning Universal Monarch to appear in a world system. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

279.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that, somehow a woman could become an Arahant who is the Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddha, appearing in a world system. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a man to become an Arahant who is the Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddha, appearing in a world system. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

280.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that somehow, a woman could become a Wheel-Turning Universal Monarch, appearing in a world system. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a man to become a Wheel-Turning Universal Monarch, appearing in a world system. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

281.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that, somehow a woman could occupy the position of Sakka, Ruler of The Gods. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a man to occupy the position of Sakka, Ruler of The Gods. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

282.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that somehow, a woman could occupy the position of Māra. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a man to occupy the position of Māra. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

283.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine that somehow, a woman could occupy the position of Brahmā. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a man to occupy the position of Brahmā. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

284.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a bodily misconduct or an evil physical behavior that could somehow produce truly desirable, lovely, pleasurable and gratifying results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a bodily misconduct or an evil physical behavior to produce truly abhorring, painful, and displeasing results. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

285.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a verbal misconduct or an evil verbal behavior that could somehow produce truly desirable, lovely, pleasurable, and gratifying results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a verbal misconduct or an evil verbal behavior to produce truly abhorring, painful, and displeasing results. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

286.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a mental misconduct or an evil mental behavior that could somehow produce truly desirable, lovely, pleasurable, and gratifying results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a mental misconduct or an evil mental behavior to produce truly abhorring, painful, and displeasing results. There is indeed the possibility for this to occur.”

Tatiya Vagga

The Third Sub Group

287.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a beneficial bodily conduct or good physical behavior that could somehow produce truly undesirable and abhorring, painful and displeasing results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a beneficial bodily conduct or good physical behavior to produce truly desirable and lovely, pleasurable and gratifying results. There is indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”

288.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a beneficial verbal conduct or good verbal behavior that could somehow produce truly undesirable and abhorring, painful and displeasing results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a beneficial verbal conduct or good verbal behavior to produce truly desirable and lovely, pleasurable and gratifying results. There is indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”

289.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible to imagine a beneficial mental conduct or good mental behavior that could somehow produce truly undesirable and abhorring, painful and displeasing results. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a beneficial mental conduct or good mental behavior to produce truly desirable and lovely, pleasurable and gratifying results. There is indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”

290.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging bodily conduct or evil physical behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to

reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

"However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging bodily conduct or evil physical behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to be reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur."

291.

"Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging verbal conduct or evil verbal behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

"However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging verbal conduct or evil verbal behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to be reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur."

292.

"Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging mental conduct or evil mental behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

"However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in damaging mental conduct or evil mental behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to be reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur."

293.

"Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial bodily conduct or good physical behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to be reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial bodily conduct or good physical behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”

294.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial verbal conduct or good verbal behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to be somehow reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial verbal conduct or good verbal behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”

295.

“Bhikkhus, it is simply impossible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial mental conduct or good mental behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to somehow be reborn in the lower realms, in the planes of misery, in the horrendous destinations, in the hells. There is absolutely no possibility for this to occur.

“However, it is quite possible for a person, who throughout life engages in beneficial mental conduct or good mental behavior, at the moment of death, once the body has broken down, to reappear in the heavenly delightful realms, where there is happiness and joy surrounding him in his next rebirth. There is, indeed, every possibility for this to occur.”



AN I

Suttas 296-377

Ekādhammo Vagga

"The One Singular Thing"

Paṭhama Vagga

The First Sub Group

296.

"Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations, to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

"And what is that one singular thing?

"It is recollecting The Buddha within your heart.

"This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna."

297.

"Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

"And what is that one singular thing?

"It is recollecting The Dhamma within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

298.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is recollecting The Sangha within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

299.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is recollecting your virtues within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

300.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is recollecting your open-handed generosity within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

301.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is recollecting the Devas within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

302.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is the mindful awareness of your in- and out-breathing.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

303.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is the mindful awareness of death within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

304.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is mindful awareness that is securely fastened onto your body.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

305.

“Bhikkhus, there is one singular thing, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.

“And what is that one singular thing?

“It is the mindful awareness of peace within your heart.

“This is the one singular thing, Bhikkhus, which when cultivated and constantly trained in, will inevitably lead you to experience disenchantment and disgust, the fading away and therefore becoming dispassionate towards things and situations; to cessation, to dwelling in peace, to directly and personally Knowing beyond the shadow of a doubt, to Awakening, to Nibbāna.”

Dutiya Vagga

The Second Sub Group

306.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more parasitical than wrong view, for it causes the arising of evil and damaging qualities which were thus far absent, while at the same time fanning the flames of those damaging and evil qualities that had already manifested and were present, as it further intensifies them, making them grow.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is wrong view in your hearts, then damaging and evil qualities will soon arise, and whatever evil and damaging qualities that are already present will simply intensify and grow further, because of your wrong view.”

307.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more comforting than Right View, for it leads to the arising of beneficial qualities which were thus far absent, while at the same time fanning the flames of those good and beneficial qualities that had already manifested and were present, as it further intensifies them, making them grow.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is Right View in your hearts, then good and beneficial qualities will soon arise, and whatever good and beneficial qualities that are already present will simply intensify and grow further, because of your Right View.”

308.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more parasitical than wrong view, for it causes the arising of evil and damaging qualities which were thus far absent, while at the same time wilting away all the beneficial and good qualities that were already present.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is wrong view in your hearts, then it will bring forth evil and damaging qualities within you, and obliterate any good or beneficial qualities you might have had.”

309.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more comforting than Right View, for it leads to the arising of good and beneficial qualities which were thus far absent, while at the same time wilting away all the evil and damaging qualities that were already present.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is Right View in your hearts, then it will bring forth good and beneficial qualities within you, and obliterate any evil and damaging qualities you might have had.”

310.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more leechlike than unwise or wrong attention, for it causes the arising of wrong view in you, which was thus far absent, while at the same time encouraging the growth of already present wrong view, by making it even stronger.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is unwise or wrong attention, then it will cause the arising of wrong view within your hearts, while increasing and solidifying the already present wrong views within you, even more.”

311.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more life-enhancing than wise radical attention, for it leads to the arising of Right View in you, which was thus far absent, while at the same time encouraging the growth of any Right View that may have already been present, increasing and making it even stronger.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when there is wise radical attention, then it will lead to the arising of Right View within your hearts, while establishing and strengthening the already present Right View within you, even more.”

312.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more threatening than holding on to wrong views, for it is the reason why so many beings find themselves reborn into miserable states, when at their moment of death, once the body breaks down, they are instantaneously dragged and dropped into horrible destinations, reappearing in the hells, to suffer unimaginable torture and pain.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of holding on to wrong views, when their bodies break down, right after the moment of death, beings are reborn into miserable states, as they are immediately dragged and dropped into horrible destinations, reappearing in the hells, to suffer unimaginable torture and pain.”

313.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing that is more soothingly reassuring than being established in Right View, for it is the reason whereby beings find themselves reappearing into delightful states, when at their moment of death, once the body breaks down, they are instantaneously reborn into happy destinations, reappearing in the Divine realms of the Devas, to experience unimaginable enjoyments.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, because of being established in Right View, when their bodies break down, right after the moment of death, beings are reborn into happy states, as they immediately reappear into heavenly destinations, in the Divine realms of the Devas, to experience unimaginable enjoyments.”

314.

“Bhikkhus, when a person impelled by his wrong view commits an action, whether a mental action, a verbal action, or a bodily action, his entire conduct will be smeared by that same view. Thus, the intentions behind his behavior, his goals, projections, leanings, and the underlying habitual patterns or drives (*saṅkhārā*) compelling him to do this or that activity, will all bring him none other than harmful, abhorring, painful, and displeasing results, causing him much suffering.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the view itself is bad.

“Imagine, Bhikkhus, a Neem seed, or the seed of a bitter gourd or that of a bitter cucumber that were to be placed into a field of moist soil. Now, all the nutrients and sustenance that the seed would absorb and draw to itself from the earth, water, air, and sunlight, would essentially and

only produce whatever it had within it to begin with, namely, its bitter flavor and unpleasant taste.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the seed is bad and unenjoyable to the taste.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, when a person impelled by his wrong view commits an action, whether a mental action, a verbal action, or a bodily action, his entire conduct will be smeared by that same view. Thus, the intentions behind his behavior, his goals, projections, leanings, and the underlying habitual patterns or drives (*saṅkhārā*) compelling him to do this or that activity, will all bring him none other than harmful, abhorring, painful, and displeasing results, causing him much suffering.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the view itself is bad.”

315.

“Bhikkhus, when a person driven by his Right View commits an action, whether a mental action, a verbal action, or a bodily action, his entire conduct will be guided by that same view. Thus, the intentions behind his behavior, his goals, projections, leanings, and the underlying habitual patterns or drives (*saṅkhārā*) compelling him to do this or that activity, will all bring him none other than truly enjoyable, desirable, lovely, pleasurable, and gratifying results, causing him much happiness.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the view itself is good.

“Imagine, Bhikkhus, a sugar cane seed, a paddy seed or a grape seed, that were to be placed into a field of moist soil. Now, all the nutrients and sustenance that the seed would absorb and draw to itself from the earth, water, air, and sunlight, would essentially and only produce whatever it had within it to begin with, namely, its sweet flavor and pleasant taste.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the seed is good and enjoyable to the taste.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, when a person guided by his Right View commits an action, whether a mental action, a verbal action, or a bodily action, his entire conduct will be guided by that same view. Thus, the intentions behind his behavior, his goals, projections, leanings, and the underlying habitual patterns or drives (*saṅkhārā*) compelling him to do this or that activity, will

all bring him none other than truly enjoyable, desirable, lovely, pleasurable, and gratifying results, causing him much happiness.

“And what is the reason for this?

“It is because the view itself is good.”

Tatiya Vagga

The Third Sub Group

316.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one person who appears in this world, born for the detriment and harm of countless people, bringing misfortune, unhappiness and suffering to the many, inflicting sorrow and pain upon both Devas and humans.

“And who is that person?

“That person, Bhikkhus, is none other than the one with wrong views, holding on to his wrong views, one with a lopsided and perverted worldview with which he influences the world around him.

“Led by his perverse and corrupt narrative, he goes on manipulating, distorting, conniving, and deceitfully pulling people away from all that is good and genuine Dhamma, and instead establishing them on false, evil, and wrong teachings, all that is adhamma.

“This, therefore, Bhikkhus, is that one person who appears in this world, born for the detriment and harm of countless people, bringing misfortune, unhappiness and suffering to the many, inflicting sorrow and pain upon both Devas and humans.”

317.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one person who appears in this world, born for the welfare and benefit of countless people, bringing good fortune, happiness and joy to the many, pervading a sense of soothing contentment and delight upon both Devas and humans.

“And who is that person?

“That person, Bhikkhus, is the one with Right View, anchored upon Right View, supported by a healthy and balanced worldview, with which he influences the world around him.

“Led by his harmonious and constructively honest objective, he goes on looking after, straightening, responsibly augmenting, and candidly pulling people away from all that is evil, false teaching and adhamma, and instead establishes them in truth, in good and right teachings, all that is Good and Genuine Dhamma.

“This, Bhikkhus, is therefore that one person who appears in this world, born for the welfare and benefit of countless people, bringing good fortune, happiness and joy to the many, pervading a sense of soothing contentment and delight upon both Devas and humans.”

318.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single thing more blameworthy than possessing wrong views in one’s heart.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, there is nothing as harmful as having wrong views, for it truly is *the most* blameworthy quality that one may possess.”

319.

“Bhikkhus, I do not know of a single person who is intentionally doing so much damage to so many; working for the detriment and harm of countless people; bringing misfortune, unhappiness and suffering to beings; inflicting sorrow and pain upon both Devas and humans, as that empty shell of a man called Makkhali!

“Imagine, Bhikkhus, a snare is placed at the mouth of a river capturing and destroying the lives of so many fish, bringing sorrow, pain, with certain death and destruction, to each and every one of them. In the same manner, Bhikkhus, that empty shell of a man called Makkhali, is himself that trap, who is intentionally doing so much damage to so many; working for the detriment and harm of countless people; bringing misfortune, unhappiness and suffering to so many beings!”

320.

“Bhikkhus, the one promoting a badly structured and poorly taught discipline or teaching while encouraging others in it, assures two things for both himself, the instigator of such evil guidance, and the one being instigated and encouraged, who goes about living and behaving according to that badly taught discipline and teaching: to be generating much wickedness and bringing to themselves nothing but evil and bad merit-making results.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being taught and followed is itself wrong and badly proclaimed.”

321.

“Bhikkhus, the one promoting a well-taught and expounded discipline or teaching while encouraging others in it, assures two things for both himself, the instigator of such good guidance, and the one being instigated and encouraged, who lives and behaves according to that well-taught discipline and teaching: to be generating much good, bringing to themselves all kinds of wholesome merit-making results.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being taught and followed is itself correct and thus well-proclaimed.”

322.

“Bhikkhus, while discussing a badly proclaimed teaching, the one expounding or relating it to others must exercise much caution and scrutiny while delivering his message, for that is *not* the responsibility of the recipient of that information, who is listening to what is being taught to him.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being discussed is itself wrong and badly proclaimed.”

323.

“Bhikkhus, while discussing a well-proclaimed teaching, the one expounding or relating it to others must exercise much caution and scrutiny while delivering his message, for that is again *not* the responsibility of the recipient of that information, who is listening to what is being taught to him.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being discussed is itself well-proclaimed and deeply multilayered.”

324.

“Bhikkhus, while dedicating himself with persevering effort in a badly proclaimed teaching and training, one will inevitably come to much suffering, sooner or later.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being followed is itself wrong and badly proclaimed.”

325.

“Bhikkhus, while being lazy and not applying any effort in a well proclaimed teaching and training, one will come to much suffering.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being discussed has nothing wrong with it, for it is well-proclaimed and beneficial, while the problem is the laziness itself.”

326.

“Bhikkhus, being lazy and not applying any effort in a badly proclaimed teaching and training, one will come to much happiness and relief, sooner or later.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching is itself wrong to begin with, and badly proclaimed; therefore, the lazy person will find himself neither being challenged nor confronted for his wrong attitude.”

327.

“Bhikkhus, while dedicating himself with persevering effort in a well proclaimed teaching and training, one will inevitably come to much happiness.

“And what is the reason for this?

“Bhikkhus, it is because the teaching being discussed is itself well-proclaimed and deeply multilayered.”

328.

“Bhikkhus, just as even a tiny bit of feces smells badly with its potent stench, whereby you immediately do your very best to get rid of it, in the same way, I declare that there is nothing in *all* of the realms that is worth cherishing or aspiring to be reborn for, even if for the tiny fraction of time it takes for you to snap your finger.

329.

“Bhikkhus, just as even a tiny bit of urine smells badly with its potent stench, in the same way, I declare that there is nothing in *all* of the realms that is worth cherishing or aspiring to be reborn for, even if for the tiny fraction of time it takes for you to snap your finger.

330.

“Bhikkhus, just as even a tiny bit of dried-up saliva smells badly with its potent stench, in the same way, I declare that there is nothing in *all* of the realms that is worth cherishing or aspiring to be reborn for, even if for the tiny fraction of time it takes for you to snap your finger.

331.

“Bhikkhus, just as even a tiny bit of dried-up pus smells badly with its potent stench, in the same way, I declare that there is nothing in *all* of the realms that is worth cherishing or aspiring to be reborn for, even if for the tiny fraction of time it takes for you to snap your finger.

332.

“Bhikkhus, just as even a tiny bit of blood smells badly with its potent stench, in the same way, I declare that there is nothing in *all* of the realms that is worth cherishing or aspiring to be reborn for, even if for the tiny fraction of time it takes for you to snap your finger.

Catuttha Vagga

The Fourth Sub Group

333.

“Bhikkhus, in the land of Jambudīpa of India, the uneven terrains and paths, hills, rivers and valleys that are hard to cross, as well as the rugged mountain ranges and their peaks, are far greater in number and more prevalent than the quiet meadows, forests, delightful parks and lotus ponds, which are so few in comparison.

“The same can be said about beings that are born on dry land, who are but a few in number when compared to the countless others that are born within water.”

334.

“Bhikkhus, the same can be said about those born as human beings, who are but a few in number when compared to the countless others that are born in the lower realms.”

335.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, those born as human beings within the middle territories where The Dhamma is proclaimed and available, are far less in number than those human beings who are born outside of the middle territories, where there is no Dhamma being proclaimed or available.”

336.

“The same can be said, Bhikkhus, about those beings who are wise, considerate, and intelligent, who are able to understand the meaning of what is being said, those with the ability to discern while scrutinizing the good teaching from the one that is evil.

“For, indeed, such beings are truly very few, when compared to the countless other beings who are dense, stubbornly pig-headed and thick, arrogant and dull-witted fools; those mindless ones who are unable to understand the meaning of what is being said, let alone discern by distinguishing the Good Teaching from the one that is evil.”

337.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, those beings who possess the Noble Eye of Wisdom are indeed very few, when compared to the countless other beings who are lost, being deeply immersed in ignorant confusion; loitering in their cyclical existences, and trapped endlessly within the clutches of *saṃsāra*.”

338.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, those beings who have the rare opportunity to see and be in the presence of The Tathāgata are indeed so very few, when compared to the countless other beings who will never get a chance to see Him or be in His presence.”

339.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, those beings who have the rare opportunity to come in contact with and listen to The Dhamma, taught by The Tathāgata, are so very few when compared to the countless other beings who will never get a chance to make contact with nor hear The Dhamma, taught by The Tathāgata.”

340.

“The same can be said, Bhikkhus, about those beings who, on hearing The Dhamma taught by The Tathāgata, retain it by keeping it close to their hearts, for such beings are truly but a few in number, when compared to the vast number of beings who neither retain nor keep The Dhamma close to their hearts.”

341.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, those beings who on hearing The Dhamma taught by The Tathāgata, examine the meaning of what has been retained and kept close in their hearts, are truly few in number, when compared to the countless number of beings, who are not interested in examining the meaning of The Dhamma that was somehow retained.”

342.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, those beings who, having understood the meaning of The Dhamma that they examined, immediately start applying it and putting into practice, are truly small in number, when compared to those countless beings, who refuse to practice according to The Dhamma.”

343.

“And, Bhikkhus, those beings who muster up the sense of urgency within their hearts towards things that cannot be delayed or postponed, are indeed too few when compared to the countless others, who continue procrastinating as they live without a sense of urgency in regards to matters that should neither be delayed nor postponed.”

344.

“And, Bhikkhus, those beings who, having the sense of urgency within their hearts, immediately go to work and apply themselves wisely, with sufficient effort and without any delay, are truly far few in number compared to those countless other beings, who although might have a sense of urgency, nevertheless, they let it wither and die in the absence of wisdom, by neither applying themselves nor putting in genuine effort, to grant life to that sense of urgency.”

345.

“The same applies, Bhikkhus, in the case of those beings who drop and move away from those things that do not matter, and set themselves squarely upon The Deathless, undeterred in their commitment and trajectory, becoming firmly established while focusing on the Heart’s Release as their *samādhi* deepens, for these beings are truly few in number when compared to those innumerable beings who do not gain any *samādhi*, let alone become resolute in the attainment of The Deathless.”

346.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, those beings who come to both gain and taste flavorful and delicious food, are so few compared to those who neither gain nor taste any flavorful or delicious food, and instead barely survive by what has been begged for and collected in a pan.”

347.

“In just the same way, Bhikkhus, those beings who come to know and understand the true meaning and depth of The Dhamma being taught, to taste The Dhamma, to personally and directly experience the delicious flavor of Release, are indeed so very few when compared to the massive and countless number of others who do not know nor understand the true meaning and depth of The Dhamma, let alone taste It, or even come close to personally and directly experiencing the delicious flavor of Release itself!

“It is for this reason, Bhikkhus, that you must strive by training yourselves with genuine effort thus:

‘We shall indeed come to know and understand the true meaning of The Dhamma that is taught; to taste The Dhamma; to personally and directly experience the delicious flavor of Release, itself!’

“*This* is the way Bhikkhus, that you must *all* strive and practice in This Dhamma and Discipline!”

348.

“Bhikkhus, in the land of Jambudīpa of India, the uneven terrains and paths, hills, rivers and valleys that are hard to cross, along with the rugged mountain ranges and their peaks, are far greater in number and more prevalent than the quiet meadows, forests, delightful parks and lotus ponds, which are so few in comparison.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so few human beings are again reborn as human beings. This, because, countless more among them are reborn into the hell realm, where they face much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering.”

349.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so few human beings are again reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the animal realm, where they face much fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

350.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so few human beings are again reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

351.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so very few human beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the hell realm, where they face much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering.”

352.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so very few human beings are reborn into the heavenly realms as Devas, for countless more are reborn into the animal realm, where they face much fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

353.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their death, when the body breaks down, so very few human beings are reborn into the heavenly realms as Devas, for countless more are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

354.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are again reborn as Devas into the heavenly realms, for countless more are reborn into the hell realm, where they face much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering.”

355.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are again reborn as Devas into the heavenly realms, for countless more are reborn into the animal realm, where they face much fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

356.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are again reborn as Devas into the heavenly realms, for countless more are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

357.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the hell realm, where they face much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering.”

358.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the animal realm, where they face much fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

359.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their divine bodies break down, so very few Devas are reborn as human beings, for countless more are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

360.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as human

beings, for countless more among them are reborn back into the hell realm, where they face, yet again, much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering."

361.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the animal realm, where they again must face fear, anguish, pain and suffering."

362.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering."

363.

"In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn back into the hell realm, where they face, yet again, much fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering."

364.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the animal realm, where they again must face fear, anguish, pain and suffering."

365.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of their departure from the hell realm, when their heavy Kammic burdens become less severe, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the

heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering."

366.

"In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realm, so very few animals are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the hell realm, where they now have to face much more fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering."

367.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realms, so very few animals are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn back into the animal realm, where they must again face fear, anguish, pain and suffering."

368.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realms, so very few animals are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering."

369.

"In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realms, so very few animals are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the hell realm, where they now have to face much more fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering."

370.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realms, so very few animals are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn back into the animal realm, where they must again face fear, anguish, pain and suffering."

371.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the animal realms, so very few animals are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

372.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the hell realm, where they now have to face much more fear, torture, terrible anguish, unimaginable pain and suffering.”

373.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn back into the animal realm, where they must again face fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

374.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as human beings, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”

375.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, at the moment of death, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the hell realm, where they now have to face much more fear, torture, terrible anguish, with unimaginable pain and suffering.”

376.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn back into the animal realm, where they must again face fear, anguish, pain and suffering.”

377.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, when their bodies break down in the realm of miserable ghosts, so very few of those beings are reborn as Devas in the heavenly realms, for countless more among them are reborn into the realm of the miserable ghosts, where they face much heart-wrenching anguish, pain, and suffering.”



AN I

Suttas 378-393

Pasakaradhamma Vagga

"Qualities that Should Be Aspired To"

378.

"Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who comfortably lives and practices in the forest, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!"

379.

"Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who lives by the morsels of food obtained through his alms round, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!"

380.

"Bhikkhus, being a Bhikkhu who gladly and contentedly wears whatever kind of robes or even rags he has obtained, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!"

381.

"Bhikkhus, being a Bhikkhu who is satisfied with only the three robes he has obtained, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!"

382.

"Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who is an eloquent teacher on The Dhamma, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!"

383.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who lives according to the rules of The Vinaya (Code of Discipline), is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

384.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who is quite learned and knowledgeable of the principles taught within The Dhamma, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

385.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who has been living the Holy Life with dedication and authenticity, despite the many great difficulties and challenges faced, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

386.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who carries himself with dignity and consideration, despite the circumstances, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

387.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu whose genuinely virtuous character and love for The Dhamma have brought him a circle of supportive followers and students, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

388.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu whose genuinely virtuous character and love for The Dhamma have brought him a large retinue of supportive followers and students, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

389.

“Bhikkhus, being a Bhikkhu who is a good son, bringing genuine honor to his family, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

390.

“Bhikkhus, being a Bhikkhu who is dignified with a striking figure, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

391.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who is an excellent speaker on The Dhamma, while elucidating and explaining its finer points beautifully through the means of similes and examples, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

392.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu who has only a few wishes left in his heart, is indeed a quality one should aspire to!”

393.

“Bhikkhus, becoming a Bhikkhu with few ailments, who is physically healthy as he maintains an equally wholesome lifestyle, now *that* indeed is a quality one should aspire to!”



AN I

Suttas 394-574

Apara Accharāsaṅghāta Vagga

"Another Section on the 'Snap of a Finger'"

394.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the *First Jhāna* even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the *First Jhāna*?"

395.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the *Second Jhāna* even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the *Second Jhāna*?"

396.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the *Third Jhāna* even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly

partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the *Third Jhāna*?"

397.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the *Fourth Jhāna* even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the *Fourth Jhāna*?"

398.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the Heart's Release through *Mettā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the Heart's Release through *Mettā* (Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness)?"

399.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the Heart's Release through *Karunā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the Heart’s Release through *Karunā* (Universal Compassion)?”

400.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the Heart’s Release through *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the Heart’s Release through *Muditā* (Universal Altruistic Joy)?”

401.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice and attain the Heart’s Release through *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the steady practice and cultivation of the Heart’s Release through *Upekkhā* (Equanimity)?”

402.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice maintaining his mindfulness while being fully attentive, even for just a snap of a finger, carefully staying with *the* most pronounced bodily experience, striving ardently but without having any thoughts of longing or resentment towards the world, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the *Satipaṭṭhāna* throughout his life?”

403.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice maintaining his mindfulness while being fully attentive, even for just a snap of a finger, carefully staying with whatever is *the* most pronounced feeling that is being experienced, mindful of it in all its transitions and states, striving ardently but without having any thoughts of longing or resentment towards the world, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the *Satipaṭṭhāna* throughout his life?”

404.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice maintaining his mindfulness while being fully attentive, even for just a snap of a finger, carefully staying with *the* most pronounced emotional state that is occurring within the Citta (*Heart*), mindful of it in all its transitions and states, striving ardently but without having any thoughts of longing or resentment towards the world, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the *Satipaṭṭhāna* throughout his life?”

405.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to practice maintaining his mindfulness while being fully attentive, even for just a snap of a finger, carefully staying with *the* most pronounced mental object or phenomena that he detects to be occurring, mindful of it in all its transitions, striving ardently but without having any thoughts of longing or resentment towards the world, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The

Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the *Satipaṭṭhāna* throughout his life?"

406.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to generate within himself the firmness of exertion even for just a snap of a finger, arousing the zeal in his heart so that no damaging activities or behaviors would even occur or arise in him, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Right Efforts throughout his life?"

407.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to generate within himself the firmness of exertion even for just a snap of a finger, arousing the zeal in his heart so as to abandon and walk away from any and all damaging activities or behaviors that may have already arisen, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Right Efforts throughout his life?"

408.

"Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to generate within himself the firmness of exertion even for just a snap of a finger, arousing the zeal to cultivate beneficial and good qualities in the heart, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food

offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Right Efforts throughout his life?”

409.

“Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to generate within himself the firmness of exertion even for just a snap of a finger, arousing the zeal to continue cultivating the beneficial and good qualities in the heart so that they flourish and maintain, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Right Endeavors throughout his life?”

410.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to exert himself even for just a snap of a finger, genuinely working to build the foundation for spiritual success by directing the *saṅkhāra* for fervent desire, in order to support the deepening of his *samādhi*, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*; living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Bases of Spiritual Success and Psychic Potency, throughout his life?”

411.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to exert himself even for just a snap of a finger, genuinely working to build the foundation for spiritual success by directing the *saṅkhāra* for persevering energy in order to support the deepening of his *samādhi*, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Bases of Spiritual Success and Psychic Potency, throughout his life?”

412.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to exert himself even for just a snap of a finger, genuinely working to build the foundation for spiritual success by directing the *saṅkhāra* for intuitive awareness in order to support the deepening of his *samādhi*, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Bases of Spiritual Success and Psychic Potency, throughout his life?”

413.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to exert himself even for just a snap of a finger, genuinely working to build the foundation for spiritual success by directing the *saṅkhāra* for examining and investigation in order to support the deepening of his *samādhi*, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Four Bases of Spiritual Success and Psychic Potency, throughout his life?”

414.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to confidently begin cultivating the spiritual faculty of faith within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Faculties throughout his life?”

415.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of persevering energy within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Faculties throughout his life?”

416.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of mindfulness within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Faculties throughout his life?”

417.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of *samādhi* within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Faculties throughout his life?”

418.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of discerning wisdom within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able

to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Faculties throughout his life?"

419.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to confidently begin cultivating the spiritual power of faith in his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Powers throughout his life?"

420.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of persevering energy in his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Powers throughout his life?"

421.

"Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of mindfulness in his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Powers throughout his life?”

422.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of *samādhi* in his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Powers throughout his life?”

423.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of discerning wisdom in his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Five Spiritual Powers throughout his life?”

424.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of Mindfulness within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

425.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of investigation of mental objects within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

426.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of persevering energy within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

427.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of spiritual joy within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

428.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of tranquility within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

429.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of *samādhi* within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

430.

“Next, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu diligently strives by cultivating the Awakening Factor of equanimity within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Seven Factors of Awakening throughout his life?”

431.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right View within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain

to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?"

432.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Intentions within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?"

433.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Communication within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?"

434.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Action within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?”

435.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Livelihood within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?”

436.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Endeavor within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?”

437.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Mindfulness within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?”

438.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to genuinely strive to cultivate Right Samādhi within his heart even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in the practice and cultivation of the Noble Eightfold Path throughout his life?”

439.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu were to mindfully perceive forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are limited, beautiful or ugly, penetrating through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

440.

“Also, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu were to mindfully perceive forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are limitless, beautiful or ugly, penetrating through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

441.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are limited, beautiful or ugly, is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

442.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are limitless, beautiful or ugly, is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

443.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are in blue color, with blue hue, and blue tint, is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

444.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are in yellow color, with yellow hue, and yellow tint, is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

445.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are in red color, with red hue, and red tint, he is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

446.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not perceiving forms internally, on seeing forms externally that are in white color, with white hue, and white tint, is able to penetrate through by going beyond them, while being aware thus: *‘yes, I do know and see,’* then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

447.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while possessing form himself, is able to internally see and be aware of material forms, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

448.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu, while not being able to internally see, yet is aware of material forms externally, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

449.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, even if for just a snap of a finger, the Bhikkhu is able to only see and be aware of the ‘beautiful’ in things, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

450.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu, having completely transcended and gone beyond the confines of the physical world and of tangibility, along with the disappearance of perceptions dealing with sensory reflexive contact, and by no longer paying any attention to the multiplicity of unending perceptions, is instead able to remain fully aware of how ‘space is infinitely boundless’ and thus enter and dwell in the dimension of ‘Boundless Infinity of Space’ even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

451.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu, having completely transcended the state of space being infinitely boundless, and by experiencing and being fully aware of how ‘consciousness is boundlessly infinite,’ is able to enter the dimension and remain fully aware of how ‘consciousness is boundlessly infinite’ even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

452.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu, having completely transcended the state of consciousness being infinitely boundless, and by experiencing and being fully aware of how ‘there is nothing at all,’ is able to enter the dimension and remain fully aware of ‘nothingness’ even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

453.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu, having completely transcended the state of nothingness, is able to enter and remain in the dimension of ‘Neither Perception nor Non-Perception’ even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

454.

“But especially, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu, having completely transcended the state of neither perception nor non-perception, is able to enter and remain in the state of ‘Cessation of Perceptions and Feelings’ even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself to penetrate through wisdom, throughout his life?”

455.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the earth *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

456.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the water *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

457.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the fire *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

458.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the air *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

459.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the blue *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

460.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the yellow *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

461.

“In the same way, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the red *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

462.

“And, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the white *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.
“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

463.

“Also, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the space *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who

is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

464.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices concentrating on the consciousness *kasiṇa* by being enveloped in its ubiquitous nature even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

465.

"In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of the horrendous even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

466.

"In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of death even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

467.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of the repulsiveness of food even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

468.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of disenchantment towards all things belonging to the world, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

469.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of impermanence even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

470.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of suffering due to impermanence, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The

Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

471.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of lack of any substantiality within suffering, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

472.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of abandoning, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

473.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of fading away and dispassion even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

474.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu practices and develops within him the perception of cessation even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

475.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates the perception of impermanence within him even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

476.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates the perception of non-substantiality within him even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

477.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates the perception of death within him even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

478.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him the perception of seeing the disgusting nature of food, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

479.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him the perception of not delighting in anything offered by the entirety of existence, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

480.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him the perception of directly seeing the skeleton even for just a snap of a finger, despite what may appear on the surface, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

481.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him the perception of seeing the body as being no more than a worm-infested corpse, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

482.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him the perception of seeing the body as a corpse that has turned black and blue, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

483.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him, even for just a snap of a finger, the perception of seeing the body as a corpse that has been split open, thus exposing whatever was hidden inside, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

484.

“Similarly, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu cultivates within him, even for just a snap of a finger, the perception of seeing the body as an unidentifiable bloated corpse, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The

Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

485.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of The Buddha, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

486.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of The Dhamma, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

487.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of The Noble Sangha, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

488.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of virtuous behavior, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*; living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

489.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of open-handed generosity, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*; living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

490.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of the Devas, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

491.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to exert himself by applying mindfulness of in and out breathing, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

492.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of death, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

493.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to exert himself by directly anchoring his mindfulness upon the body, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

494.

“And if, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu were to cultivate within himself the recollection of peace and serenity, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.
“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

495.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **faith** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu

who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

496.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **persevering energy** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

497.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **mindfulness** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

498.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **samādhi** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

499.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **discerning wisdom** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

500.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **faith** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

501.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **persevering energy** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

502.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **mindfulness** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The

Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

503.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **samādhi** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

504.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **discerning wisdom** with the support of the *First Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

505.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **faith** with the support of the *Second Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

506.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **persevering energy** with the support of the *Second Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

507.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **mindfulness** with the support of the *Second Jhāna*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

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"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

556.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **persevering energy** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not being blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

557.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **mindfulness** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.
"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

558.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **samādhi** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

559.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **discerning wisdom** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

560.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **faith** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

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“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **persevering energy** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

562.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **mindfulness** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

563.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **samādhi** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

564.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **discerning wisdom** with the support of *Muditā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.
“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

565.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **faith** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

566.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **persevering energy** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

567.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **mindfulness** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

568.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **samādhi** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

569.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual faculty of **discerning wisdom** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

570.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **faith** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

571.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **persevering energy** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.
"And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?"

572.

"Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **mindfulness** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

573.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **samādhi** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?”

574.

“Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu were to cultivate the spiritual power of **discerning wisdom** with the support of *Upekkhā*, even for just a snap of a finger, then he is to be declared a Bhikkhu who is able to attain to *jhāna*, living and training according to The Dispensation of The Teacher. Thus, he would be rightfully and blamelessly partaking of the food offered to him by the public, and therefore not be blameworthy in consuming all that is offered to him.

“And if this can be said about such a Bhikkhu, then how much more could be said about the Bhikkhu, who is fully dedicated and immersed in training himself in it, throughout his life?

AN I

Suttas 575-615

Kāyagatāsati Vagga

"Mindfulness Anchored Upon the Body"

575.

"Bhikkhus, whoever carefully looks upon the vast and great ocean, will also see within it the innumerable small rivulets and great rivers that flow and merge into it.

"In the same manner, Bhikkhus, whoever directs one's attention by cultivating mindfulness of the body, returning again and again back to mindfully staying with the body, will soon enough also see how all the beneficial and good qualities that directly lead one to supreme knowledge, are included within mindfulness that is directed and fastened to the body."

576.

"Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the full maturation and pinnacle of your sense of urgency.

"And what is that one single thing?

"It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the full maturation and pinnacle of your sense of urgency."

577.

"Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the achievement of the Highest Good.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the achievement of the Highest Good.”

578.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the ultimate safety and security that is freedom from bondage.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the ultimate safety and security that is freedom from bondage.”

579.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to having consistent mindfulness and crystal-clear awareness.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to having consistent mindfulness and crystal-clear awareness.”

580.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to finally gain the deep understanding and vision.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to finally gain the deep understanding and vision.”

581.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to live and continue experiencing a state of soothing happiness throughout, right here, in *this* very life.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to live and continue experiencing a state of soothing happiness throughout, right here, in *this* very life.”

582.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, by returning back it to again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the attainment of the Fruit of Perfect Release and the Certainty in Directly Knowing that you are now finally Released!

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, by returning back to it again and again, it will spiral into and directly lead you to the attainment of the Fruit of Perfect Release and the Certainty in Directly Knowing that you are now finally Released!”

583.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, by returning back to it again and again, it will softly allow the body to become tranquil and relaxed, whereby the heart also will settle down, forgetting its agitations, while thinking and pondering quiet down and cease, as a result of which all those wholesome factors necessary for the Direct Knowledge of Awakening to take place, will perfectly line up and reach their fulfillment.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will softly allow the body to become tranquil and relaxed, whereby the heart also will settle down, forgetting its agitations, while thinking and pondering quiet down and cease, as a result of which all those wholesome factors necessary for the Direct Knowledge of Awakening to take place, will perfectly line up and reach their fulfillment.”

584.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, by returning back to it again and again, any evil or damaging states of mind which have not yet arisen, will never get their chance to surface, meanwhile all those evil and damaging states of mind which had already surfaced and arisen, will be immediately abandoned and cut off.

“Now, what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, any evil or damaging states of mind which have not yet arisen, will never get their chance to surface, meanwhile all those evil and damaging states of mind which had already surfaced and arisen, will be immediately abandoned and cut off.”

585.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, by returning back to it again and again, any good and beneficial states of mind that have not yet arisen, will be given the opportunity to immediately surface and manifest, meanwhile all those other good and beneficial states of mind which had already surfaced and arisen, will be strengthened and allowed to flourish and reach fulfillment.

“Now, what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, any good and beneficial states of mind that have not yet arisen, will be given the opportunity to immediately surface and manifest, meanwhile all those other good and beneficial states of mind which had already surfaced and arisen, will be strengthened and allowed to flourish and reach fulfillment.”

586.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the obliteration of ignorance.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead you to the obliteration of ignorance.”

587.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the arising of True Understanding in the Heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the arising of True Understanding in the Heart.”

588.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the abandonment and termination of the conceit: *‘I am.’*

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the abandonment and termination of the conceit: *‘I am.’*

589.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the removal of all hidden negative tendencies (*anusayā*).

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the removal of all hidden negative tendencies.”

590.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the abandoning and destruction of the fetters (*saṃyojanā*).

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to the abandoning and destruction of the fetters.”

591.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead you to possess decisive and unmistakable wisdom.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead you to possess decisive and unmistakable wisdom.”

592.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to Nibbāna, without you holding on to anything.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to Nibbāna, without you holding on to anything.”

593.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full comprehension of the mental spheres.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full comprehension of the mental spheres.”

594.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full penetration of the diverse mental spheres.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full penetration of the diverse mental spheres.”

595.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full penetrative understanding of the diverse mental spheres.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will directly lead to full penetrative understanding of the diverse mental spheres.”

596.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Stream-Winning.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Stream-Winning.”

597.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Once-Returning.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Once-Returning.”

598.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Non-Returning.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Non-Returning.”

599.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Arahanthood.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it straightaway takes you to the very realization of the Fruit of Arahanthood.”

600.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it turns into genuine wisdom in the heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it turns into genuine wisdom in the heart.”

601.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it nurtures and leads to the flourishing of genuine wisdom in the heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it nurtures and leads to the flourishing of genuine wisdom in the heart.”

602.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it shines and pervades genuine wisdom throughout.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it shines and pervades genuine wisdom throughout.”

603.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it turns into ever present genuine wisdom that is always with you.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it turns into ever present genuine wisdom that is always with you.”

604.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it deepens the versatility of genuine wisdom in the heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it deepens the versatility of genuine wisdom in the heart.”

605.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it opens up the genuine wisdom in the heart, making it vast and boundless.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it opens up the genuine wisdom in the heart, making it vast and boundless.”

606.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge while deepening the genuine wisdom in the heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge while deepening the genuine wisdom in the heart.”

607.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it transforms into genuine wisdom that is unsurpassable.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it transforms into genuine wisdom that is unsurpassable.”

608.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it constantly unfolds the living genuine wisdom in the heart.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it constantly unfolds the living genuine wisdom in the heart.”

609.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom abundant, throughout.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom abundant, throughout.”

610.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart instantaneously fast.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart instantaneously fast.”

611.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart lively and nimble.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart lively and nimble.”

612.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart become even more dynamic and colorful in its nuances.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart become even more dynamic and colorful in its nuances.”

613.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart become spontaneous.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it makes the genuine wisdom in the heart become spontaneous.”

614.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it keeps the genuine wisdom in the heart fresh and always sharp.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge as it keeps the genuine wisdom in the heart fresh and always sharp.”

615.

“Bhikkhus, there is that one single thing, which when you cultivate to perfection, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge, while constantly developing the genuine wisdom in the heart into its penetrative perfection.

“And what is that one single thing?

“It is mindfulness firmly anchored upon the body. Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you cultivate mindfulness of the body, by constantly directing and anchoring it upon the body, returning back to it again and again, it will spiral and converge, while constantly developing the genuine wisdom in the heart into its penetrative perfection.”



AN I

Suttas 616-627

Amata Vagga

"The Deathless"

616.

"Bhikkhus, whoever does not engage the mind by directing his attention onto the body, by not returning back to it again and again nor staying with it, *is* the person who deprives himself of the experience of The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

617.

"Bhikkhus, whoever engages the mind by directing his attention onto the body, returning back to it again and again and staying with it, *is* the person who does indeed experience The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

618.

"Bhikkhus, whoever loses interest and stops engaging his mind, by no longer directing his attention onto the body, *is* the person who is missing out, for he has fallen away from ever experiencing The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

619.

“Bhikkhus, all those who fail in their efforts to observe the mind by establishing it on the body, *are* the ones who fail in ever experiencing The Deathless!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!”

620.

“Bhikkhus, all those who remain heedless and inattentive by their neglect of the mind, as it goes on being disconnected from the body, *are* the ones who fail in ever experiencing The Deathless!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!”

621.

“Bhikkhus, whoever is forgetful to engage his mind by directing his attention onto the body, *is* the person who has forgotten all about The Deathless!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!”

622.

“Bhikkhus, whoever is unwilling to engage his mind by directing his attention onto the body, *is* the person who is unwilling to experience The Deathless!

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!”

623.

“Bhikkhus, whoever refuses to cultivate the mind by directing his attention onto the body, returning back to it again and again and staying with it, *is* the person who refuses to experience The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

624.

"Bhikkhus, whoever has not put the time and energy in developing the mind by directing his attention onto the body, making it return back to the body, again and again, and staying with it, *is* the person who has not put the time and energy to experience The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

625.

"Bhikkhus, whoever does not get to experience the insights to be gained from directing his attention onto the body, by returning back to it, again and again, and staying with it, *is* the person who does not get to experience The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

626.

"Bhikkhus, all those who do not penetrate through to directly know the importance of anchoring their mindfulness onto the body, *are* the ones who do not penetrate through to directly know and experience The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

627.

"Bhikkhus, whoever does not practice diligently to unmistakably realize for himself what it means to anchor his mindfulness onto the body, *is* the person who deprives himself of ever experiencing the unmistakable realization of The Deathless!

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, firmly anchor your mindfulness upon the body, for it *will* most certainly take you straight to The Deathless!"

(Here ends Book of the Ones)



Sādhu Sādhu Sādhu

Translated by Bhikkhu Candana

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a final note

As this volume comes to a close, the words of The Blessed One and the Noble Disciples continue to echo beyond the page.

The Dhamma does not end where a book ends. It truly lives whenever and wherever it is reflected upon, practiced… and realized.

This work has been prepared with a single guiding intention: that The Teachings be preserved and made available in a way that allows their voice to come through clearly, directly, and without unnecessary interruptions, let alone any obstructions.

The Dhamma has always been something to be heard, contemplated, and lived — *not* merely studied. For this reason, the effort throughout this project has been to keep the presentation as faithful, transparent, and uninterrupted as possible, so that readers may encounter The Blessed One's Teachings in their own immediacy and depth.

The *Aṅguttara Nikāya*, with its practical and graduated structure, speaks intimately to the conditions of human life. Its teachings touch the struggles, responsibilities, relationships, and aspirations shared by people in every era. Preserving such guidance is not an academic task alone, but a living service to beings who seek clarity, peace, and Liberation.

Whatever goodness may have arisen through the preparation of this volume is not held as personal possession. It is offered in gratitude to the many individuals whose quiet generosity and support have made this work possible, and it is shared with all who turn toward The Dhamma with sincerity. May the merit extend outward without measure.

May these volumes travel far, as they meet (and "be greeted" by) all those who are ready for them…

